Poem of Gilgameš – Standard Babylonian XII: ""Today, Had I Only Left The Ball In The Carpenter's Workshop!"

▼ Contents

1 5
2 5
3 6
4 6
5 6
6 7
7 7
8 7
9 8
10 8
11 8
12 9
13 9
14 9
15 10
16 10
17 10
18 10
19 11
20 11
21 12
22 12
23 12
24 13
25 13
26 13
27 14
28 14

29 14
30 15
31 16
32 16
33 16
34 17
35 17
36 17
37 18
37a 18
38 18
39 19
40 19
41 19
42 19
43 20
44 20
45 20
46 20
47 21
48 21
49 21
50 22
51 22
52 22
53 22
54 23
55 23
56 24
57 24
58 24
59 24
60 25
61 25
62 26
63 26

64 26
65 26
66 27
67 27
68 27
69 28
70 28
71 28
72 29
73 29
74 29
75 29
76 30
77 30
78 30
79 31
80 31
81 31
82 32
83 32
84 32
85 33
86 33
87 33
88 34
89 34
90 34
91 34
92 34
93 35
94 35
95 35
96 36
97 36
98 37
99 37

100 37
101 38
102 38
103 39
104 39
105 39
106 40
107 40
108 40
109 41
110 41
111 41
112 42
113 42
114 42
115 42
116 43
117 43
118 43
119 44
129 44
130 44
131 44
132 44
133 44
134 45
135 45
136 45
137 45
144 45
145 46
146 46
147 47
148 47
149 48
150 48

151	49
152	49
153	49

- Source: eBL corpus – https://www.ebl.lmu.de/corpus/L/1/4/Standard%20Babylonian/XII
- API: https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/4/chapters/Standard%20Babylonian/XII/display
- Edition: Andrew R. George (editor); Geraldina Rozzi (revision); Enrique Jiménez (revision)
- Translation: Andrew R. George
- Generated by `tools/ebl_fetch.py` on 2026-10-17 – do not edit by hand; re-run the tool instead.

Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (`|` metrical foot, `||` caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

1

- **N:** ūma | pukku | ina bīt (|) nagāri | lū ēz[ib]
- **T:** “Today, had I only left the ball in the carpenter’s workshop!
- **L:** *ūma* ← ūmu I “pl. m. & f. day”; *pukku* ← pukku I “(a wooden ring or ball)? O/jB, used in game with *mekkû*”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *bīt* ← bītu I “m.”; *nagāri* ← nagāru I “joiner, carpenter maker of furniture, doors, boats”; *lū* ← lū I “let it be”; *ēz[ib]* ← ezēbu I “to leave, leave behind”
- **Note:** On the identification of *pukku* and *mekkû*, see the discussion in [RN117: 898–900], who follows Landsberger’s interpretation of the terms as equipment used to play “a kind of piggyback golf or solo polo.” See also [rollinger2006gilgamesch], who interprets them as instruments to play a “Stockballspiel”; and [steinkeller2018reluctant: 159–168], according to whom the terms refer to “some kind of a percussion instrument or noise maker, which Gilgameš used to mobilize the men of Uruk for corvée work.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 172)

```
NinNA1 i 1. [x x x x x x x na-g]a-ri lu-u₂# [x x]
NinNAQuo1 vi 39. u₄-ma pu-uk-ku ina E₂# {lu₂}NAGAR lu e-z[ib]
NinNAQuo2 vi 24'. [x x p]u-uk-ku ina E₂ {lu₂}NAGAR lu-u₂ e#-[zib]
```

2

- **N:** [aššat (|) nagāri | kī umm]i | ālittīya | lū [ēzib]
- **T:** [O carpenter’s wife who is like the mother] who bore me! Had I only [left it!]

- **L:** *[aššat* ← aššatu I “wife”; *nagāri* ← nagāru I “joiner, carpenter maker of furniture, doors, boats”; *kī* ← kī I “like”; *umm]i* ← ummu I “f. mother”; *ālittīya* ← alādu I “to give birth (to)”; *lū* ← lū I “let it be”; *[ēzib]* ← ezēbu I “to leave, leave behind”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 173)

```
NinNA1 i 2. [x x x x x x x x x um-m]i a#-lit#-ti-ia lu-u₂# [e-zib]
```

3

- **N:** m[ārat (|) nagāri | ša kī a]hātī[ya | ṣ]ehherti | l[ū ēzib]
- **T:** O [carpenter’s daughter who is like my] little sister! Had [I only left it!]
- **L:** *m[ārat* ← mārtu I “daughter”; *nagāri* ← nagāru I “joiner, carpenter maker of furniture, doors, boats”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *kī* ← kī I “like”; *a]hātī[ya* ← ahātu I “pl. OA *ahuātum*, OB *ahhātu* sister (natural) sister”; *ṣ]ehherti* ← ṣehhertu I; *l[ū* ← lū I “let it be”; *ēzib]* ← ezēbu I “to leave, leave behind”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 174)

```
NinNA1 i 3. [x x {lu₂}na-ga-ri ša₂ ki-i a]-ha#-ti#-[ia ṣ]e-her-ti lu-[u₂ e-zib]
NinNA2 i 3. D[UMU.MUNUS x x x x x x x x x x x x x x x x]
```

4

- **N:** ūma | pu[kku] | ana erṣeti | imq[utanni]
- **T:** Today [the] ball fell down to the Netherworld,
- **L:** *ūma* ← ūmu I “pl. m. & f. day”; *pu[kku]* ← pukku I “(a wooden ring or ball)? O/jB, used in game with *mekkû*”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *imq[utanni]* ← maqātu I “to fall”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 900]: “4-5. The Akkadian text is witness to a tradition in which the Sumerian of BN 175-6 evidently read simply *{giš*ellag.mu kur.še₃ mu.da.šub} / *{giš*E.KID.ma.mu ganzir.še₃ mu.da.šub}. As regards the restoration of the final word, *imqutannima* is suggested by XII 57-8 but *imqutanni* by XII 65-6.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 175); L I.4 SB "XII" 57; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 65

```
NinNA1 i 4. [x x x x x x x KI-t]i₃ i[m-qu-tan-ni]
NinNA2 i 4. U₄ pu-u[k-ku x x x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 4. [x x x x] a#-na# KI#-ti₃# im#-q[u-tan-ni]
```

5

- **N:** mikkê(ʾa) | ana erṣeti | i[mqutanni-(ma)]
- **T:** my mallet fell [down] to the Netherworld!’

- **L:** *mikkê(ʾa)* ← mekkû I “O/jB”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *i[mqutanni-(ma)]* ← maqātu I “to fall”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 176); L I.4 SB "XII" 58; L I.4 SB "XII" 66

```
NinNA1 i 5. [x x x x x x K]I-ti₃# i[m-qu-tan-ni]
NinNA2 i 5. mi-ik-ke-e#-[(ia) x x x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 5. [mi]-ik#-ke#-ia# a-na KI-ti₃ [x x x x]
```

6

- **N:** [e]nkīdu | gilgāmeš | i[ppalšu?]
- **T:** Enkidu [answered] Gilgameš:
- **L:** *[e]nkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *i[ppalšu?]* ← apālu I “to pay”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 900]: “6. Here the Akkadian follows the tradition of Sumerian MS H (BN 177), rather than those of MSS rVW.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 177)

```
NinNA1 i 6. [x x x x {d}GIŠ-g]im₂-maš i[p-pal?-šu]
BabNB1 i 6. [{d}+e]n-ki-du₃ {d}GIŠ-gim₂-maš [x x x]
```

7

- **N:** bēlī | mīnâ | tabki | libbaka | [lemun]
- **T:** ‘My lord, why did you weep, your heart being [vexed]?
- **L:** *bēlī* ← bēlu I “lord”; *mīnâ* ← mīnu I “what? OAkk, OB, MA, Nuzi, NB in PN”; *tabki* ← bakû I “to weep”; *libbaka* ← libbu I “inner body”; *[lemun]* ← lemēnu I “to be(come) bad”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 178)

```
NinNA1 i 7. [x x x x x x tab-k]i lib₃-ba-ka [x x]
NinNA2 i 6. be-li₂ mi#-na#-[a x x x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 7. be-lum mi-LA-a tab-ki#-ma lib₃-ba-ka [le-mun]
```

8

- **N:** ūma | pukka | ultu erṣeti | anāku | uš[ellâkka]
- **T:** Today I myself shall [bring you] the ball up from the Netherworld,
- **L:** *ūma* ← ūmu I “pl. m. & f. day”; *pukka* ← pukku I “(a wooden ring or ball)? O/jB, used in game with *mekkû*”; *ultu* ← ištu I “from, out of”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *anāku* ← anāku I “I”; *uš[ellâkka]* ← elû III “to go up, arise”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 900]: “8. In retaining *ūma* this line follows MSS rVW not MS H, which omits *u₄.da* (l. 179).”

- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 179)

```
NinNA1 i 8. [x x x x] ul#-tu KI-ti₃ a-na-ku [x x x x x]
NinNA2 i 7. U₄ pu-u[k-ku x x x x x x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 8. U₄ pu-uk-ku ul-tu KI-ti₃ ana-ku u₂-š[e-el-lak-ka]
```

9

- **N:** mikkê | ultu erṣeti | anāku | uše[llâkka]
- **T:** I myself shall [bring you] your mallet up from the Netherworld!’
- **L:** *mikkê* ← mekkû I “O/jB”; *ultu* ← ištu I “from, out of”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *anāku* ← anāku I “I”; *uše[llâkka]* ← elû III “to go up, arise”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 180)

```
NinNA3a i 9. mi-i[k-ke-e x x x x x x x x x x x]
NinNA1 i 9. [me-ek-ke]-e# ul#-tu KI-ti₃ a-na-ku [x x x x x]
NinNA2 i 8. mi-ik-k[e-e x x x x x x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 9. me-ek-ke-e ul-tu KI-ti₃ ana-ku u₂-še-[el-lak-ka]
```

10

- **N:** gilgāmeš | enkīdu | [ippal?]
- **T:** Gilgameš [answered] Enkidu:·
- **L:** *gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *[ippal?]* ← apālu I “to pay”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 181)

```
NinNA3a i 10. {d}GIŠ-gim₂#-maš# [x x x x x x]
NinNA1 i 10. [{d}GIŠ]-maš {d}+en-ki-du₃ [x x]
NinNA2 i 9. {d}GIŠ-g[im₂-maš x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 10. {d}GIŠ-gim₂-maš {d}+en-ki-du₃ [ip-pal?]
```

11

- **N:** šumma | ana erṣeti | [turrad]
- **T:** ‘If [you are going to descend] to the Netherworld,
- **L:** *šumma* ← šumma I “if (NB only lit.”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *[turrad]* ← warādu I “to go down”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 182)

```
NinNA3a i 11. šum-ma a-na# [x x]
NinNA1 i 11. [šum-m]a a-na KI-ti₃ [tur-rad]
NinNA2 i 10. šum-ma [x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 11. šum-ma a-na KI-ti₃ [x x]
```

12

- **N:** ana aširtīya | [lū tašaddad]
- **T:** [you should pay heed to] my instructions!
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I "(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*..."; *aširtīya* ← aširtu I; *[lū* ← lū I "let it be"; *tašaddad]* ← šadādu I "to drag"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 183); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 32

```
NinNA3a i 12. a-na a-ši-ir-ti-ia# [lu-u₂ ta-šad-da-ad]
NinNA1 i 12. [x x] a-ši-ir-ti-ia₂ [x x x x x x]
NinNA2 i 11. a#-na# a#-[ši-ir-ti-ia x x x x x x]
BabNB1 i 12. [a-n]a a-ši-ir-ti#-ia# [x x x x x x]
```

13

- **N:** ṣubāta | zakâ | [lā taltabbiš]
- **T:** [You must not dress in] a clean garment,
- **L:** *ṣubāta* ← ṣubātu I "textile, garment"; *zakâ* ← zakû I "f. *zakūtu(m)* (NB *cf. zakītu*)"; *[lā* ← lā I "not, no"; *taltabbiš]* ← labāšu I "to clothe o.s."
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 185); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 33

```
NinNA3a i 13. ṣu-ba-ta za-ka-a [la tal-tab-biš]
NinNA1 i 13. [ṣu-b]a-a-ta za-ka-a [x x x x]
BabNB1 i 13. [TUG₂] KU₃# [x x x x]
```

14

- **N:** kīma ubārātā-ma | uʾadd[ûka]
- **T:** they will identify [you] as a stranger!
- **L:** *kīma* ← kīma I "like"; *ubārātā-ma* ← ubāru I "~ (resident) alien"; *uʾadd[ûka]* ← wadû I "to know"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 186); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 34

```
NinNA3a i 14. ki-ma u₂-ba#-ra#-ta-ma u₂-a#-ad#-d[u-ka]
NinNA1 i 14. [ki-m]a u₂-ba-ra-ta-ma [x x x x x]
```

15

- **N:** šaman (|) pūri | ṭāba | lā tappaši[š]
- **T:** You must not anoint yourself with sweet oil from the flask,
- **L:** *šaman* ← šamnu I “oil”; *pūri* ← pūru I “(stone) bowl MA, M/jB”; *ṭāba* ← ṭābu I “good”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tappaši[š]* ← pašāšu I “to anoint”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 187); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 35

```
NinNA3a i 15. ša-man pu-u₂-ri ṭa-a-ba la tap-pa-ši-i[š]
NinNA1 i 15. [ša₂-m]an pu-u₂-ri ṭa-a-bu [x x x x x]
```

16

- **N:** ana irīšīšu | ipahhurūka
- **T:** at the smell of it they will gather around you!
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *irīšīšu* ← erīšu I “scent, fragrance Bab. of person, meal, water, house”; *ipahhurūka* ← pahāru II “to gather”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 900]: “16. The Akkadian *ana irīšīšu* renders the Nippur tradition of MSS HYZ (*ir.si.im.bi.še₃*), not the Ur tradition of MS r (*ir.sim.zu.še₃*).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 188); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 36

```
NinNA3a i 16. a-na i-ri-ši-šu i#-pah-hu-ru-ka
NinNA1 i 16. [x x] i#-ri-ši-šu [x x x x x]
```

17

- **N:** tilpāna | ana erṣeti | lā tanassuk
- **T:** You must not hurl a throwstick at the Netherworld,
- **L:** *tilpāna* ← tilpānu I “f. bow Bab. as weapon”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tanassuk* ← nasāku I “to throw (down)”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 900]: “17. The preposition *ana*, when *ina* is expected, is the result of a misparsing of Sum. *kur.ra* as *kur* and dative instead of *kur* and locative.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 189); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 37

```
NinNA3a i 17. til-pa-na a-na KI-ti₃# la ta-na-suk
NinNA1 i 17. [til-p]a-na a-na KI-ti₃# [x x x x]
```

18

- **N:** ša ina tilpāni | mahṣū | ilammûka
- **T:** those struck by the throwstick will surround you!

- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *tilpāni* ← tilpānu I “f. bow Bab. as weapon”; *mahṣū* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”; *ilammûka* ← lawû II “to surround”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 190); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 38

```
NinNA3a i 18. ša i-na til-pa-na ma[h-ṣ]u i-lam-mu-ka
NinNA1 i 18. [ša₂ ina] til-pa-nu mah-ṣ[u x x x x]
```

19

- **N:** šabbiṭa | ana qātīka | lā tanašši
- **T:** You must not carry a staff in your hand,
- **L:** *šabbiṭa* ← šabbiṭu I “staff, sceptre jB”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *qātīka* ← qātu I “f.”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tanašši* ← našû II “to lift, carry”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 900]: “19. As its etymology suggests (cf. *šabāṭu*, ‘to strike’), the *šabbiṭu*, a rod of cornel wood (Sum. *{gi*šma.nu}), is not a badge of office but a deliverer of violence. As such it is carried by soldiers (cf. *CAD* Š/I s.v. *šabbiṭu* B) and, according to the poet of the Vision of Kummâ, brandished at new arrivals in the Netherworld by Nergal, the terrible king of the Babylonian Hades, as a death-dealing instrument ([RN384: no. 32 rev. 15-16]): *šab-bi-ṭu si-mat ilu-ti-šu₂ ... i-ša₂-a-ṭa a-na da-ke-[ia]*, ‘he was wielding the staff appropriate to his divine office (as if) to kill [me]’. This allusion, in particular, explains why the shades of the dead will tremble in terror.” See also [RN2813xs: 274]: “However, Akkadian *šabbiṭu* is not a translation of the Sumerian *{ĝiš*ma-nu} but, rather, a re-interpretation by the Akkadian compiler. As the shades are already dead, they are certainly not afraid of death. Rather, they fear the *{ĝiš*ma-nu} because it is an exorcist tool.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 191)

```
NinNA3a i 19. šab-bi-ṭu a-na Š[U.MIN-k]a la ta-na-aš₂-ši
NinNA1 i 19. [šab]-bi-ṭu a-na ŠU.MIN-k[a x x x x x]
```

20

- **N:** eṭemmū | i’arrurūka
- **T:** the shades will tremble before you!
- **L:** *eṭemmū* ← eṭemmu I “ghost (of dead person) receiving libations, offerings”; *i’arrurūka* ← arāru III “to be convulsed Bab.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 192); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 40

```
NinNA3a i 20. e-ṭem-mu [(x)] i-ar-ru-ru-ka
NinNA1 i 20. e#-ṭem#-mu [x x x x x]
```

21

- **N:** šēnī | ina šēpīka | lā tašên
- **T:** You must not wear sandals on your feet,
- **L:** *šēnī* ← šēnu I “f.”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *šēpīka* ← šēpu I “f., often du.”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tašên* ← šênu I “to put on (shoes) jB”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 193); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 41

```
NinNA3a i 21. še-e-ni a-n[a GIR3-MIN]-ka la ta-še-ni
NinNA1 i 21. še-e-ni ina GIR3-MIN-ka [x x x x]
```

22

- **N:** rigma | ana erṣeti | lā tašakkan
- **T:** you must not make a noise in the Netherworld!
- **L:** *rigma* ← rigmu I “pl. f. voice, cry, noise voice of deity, human”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tašakkan* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 900–901]: “22. The Sumerian sources for BN 194 disagree as to what word precedes the verb. MS r, from Ur, has *KA*, which is best read as gu_3 (so [gadd1933epic: 133], and [shaffer1963sumerian: 75]) and provides the translator’s *rigmu*. Shaffer saw that the trace in MS Y, from Nippur, was of a different sign but he offered no decipherment. Help is provided by the narrative parallel, where Nippur MSS HZ and MS V appear to have du_6. *(*du_6*)-n* and *BUL.BUL* = $tu_{13}.tu_{13}$ respectively (BN 216). Since the latter means ‘to quake’, the former may be taken as an orthographic variant for synonymous $BUR_2.BUR_2 = du_9.du_9$ or $dun_5.dun_5$ (for both verbs in lexical equations with *nâšu* see *CAD* N/2, p. 113). The trace of MS Y in BN 194 seems to be this verb in its conventional spelling. The Nippur tradition is thus that the wearing of shoes in the Netherworld upsets the shades of the dead by making the ground shake. The shift from the idea of shaking to the idea of noise, in which the Ur manuscript is followed by the Akkadian text, perhaps came about through a misunderstanding of du_9 or du_6 as $du_{11} = KA = gu_3$.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 194); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 42

```
NinNA3a i 22. ri-ig-ma a-n[a KI-t]i3 la ta-šak-kan
NinNA1 i 22. ri-ig-mu ina KI-ti3 [x x x x]
```

23

- **N:** aššatka | ša tarammu | lā tanaššiq
- **T:** You must not kiss the wife you love,
- **L:** *aššatka* ← aššatu I “wife”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tarammu* ← râmu II “to love”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tanaššiq* ← našāqu I “to kiss”

- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 195); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 43

```
NinNA3a i 23. aš₂-šat-ka ša [ta-ram-m]u la ta-na-ši[q]
NinNA1 i 23. aš₂-šat-ka ša₂ ta-ram-mu [x x x x]
```

24

- **N:** aššatka | ša tazerru | lā tamahhaṣ
- **T:** you must not strike the wife you hate,
- **L:** *aššatka* ← aššatu I “wife”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tazerru* ← zêru I “to dislike, hate”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tamahhaṣ* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 196); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 44

```
NinNA3a i 24. aš₂-šat-ka ša t[a-ze-r]u la ta-mah-haṣ
NinNA1 i 24. aš₂-šat-ka ša₂ ta-ze-ru [x x x x]
BabNB2 i 1'. [x x x x x x x x ta-ma]h-haṣ
```

25

- **N:** mārāka | ša tarammu | lā tanaššiq
- **T:** you must not kiss the son you love,
- **L:** *mārāka* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tarammu* ← râmu II “to love”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tanaššiq* ← našāqu I “to kiss”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 197); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 45

```
NinNA3a i 25. ma-ra-ka ša t[a-ram-mu] la ta-na-šiq
NinNA1 i 25. ma-ra-ka ša₂ ta-ram-mu [x x x x]
BabNB2 i 2'. [x x x x x x x x ta-n]a-aš₂-ši-iq
```

26

- **N:** mārāka | ša tazerru! | lā tamahhaṣ
- **T:** you must not strike the son you hate,
- **L:** *mārāka* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tazerru!* ← zêru I “to dislike, hate”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *tamahhaṣ* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 198); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 46

```
NinNA3a i 26. ma-ra-ka ša t[a-ze-r]u la ta-mah-haṣ
NinNA1 i 26. ma-ra-ka ša₂ ta-ze-ru [x x x x x]
BabNB2 i 3'. [x x x x x x x x ta]-mah-haṣ
```

27

- **N:** tazzimti | erṣeti | i[ṣ]abbatka
- **T:** the outcry of the Netherworld will seize you!
- **L:** *tazzimti* ← tazzimtu I “? complaint Bab., OA”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *i[ṣ]abbatka* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 199); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 47

```
NinNA3a i 27. ta-zi-im-ti [KI-t]i₃ i-[ṣ]ab-bat-ka
NinNA1 i 27. ta-az-zi-im-tu₄ KI-ti₃ [x x x x]
BabNB2 i 4'. [x x x x x x x i-ṣab-bat]-ka
```

28

- **N:** ša ṣallat | ša ṣallat | ummi (|) ninazu | ša ṣallat
- **T:** The one who lies, the one who lies, the mother of Ninazu who lies,
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ṣallat* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ṣallat* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”; *ummi* ← ummu I “f. mother”; *ninazu* ← Ninazu I; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ṣallat* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 901]: “28. The epithet ‘mother of Ninazu’ is also used of Ereškigal in the doxology of the Death of Bilgames in the version from Mê-Turan ([RN24: 36, 305]). For Ninazu as Ereškigal’s son see further the Collection of Sumerian Temple Hymns 182 etc. ([RN625: 27]; cf. [lambert1980theology: 61]; F. A. M.Wiggermann, *RLA* IX, p. 330).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 200-201); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 48

```
NinNA3a i 28. ša₂ ṣal-lat ša₂ ṣal-l[at x x {d}ni]n-a-zu ša₂ ṣal-lat
NinNA1 i 28. ša₂ ṣal-lat ša₂ ṣal-lat um-mu {d}nin-a-zu [x x x]
BabNB2 i 5'. [x x x x x x x x x x x x š]a ṣal-lat
```

29

- **N:** būdāša | ellētu | ṣubāta | ul kuttumā
- **T:** her gleaming shoulders are not draped in a garment,
- **L:** *būdāša* ← būdu II “f. shoulder OAkk, Bab. of human beings”; *ellētu* ← ellu I “pure”; *ṣubāta* ← ṣubātu I “textile, garment”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *kuttumā* ← katāmu I “to cover”

- **Note:** See [RN117: 901]: “29-30. As Shaffer had already implied, the Akkadian of these lines renders the Sumerian of Inanna’s Descent 232-3 // 259-60 more nearly than that of BN 202-3. The adjective *ku₃* = *ellu*, used of shoulders, has connotations of cclour: like other residents of the Netherworld Ereškigal is deprived of sun, and her gleaming white flesh stands out in the dark. The *bur.šagan* is translated here as *pūr šappāti* but in l. 50 as *pūr šikkati*, reflecting the dual entries in lexical texts: *[ša-gan dug.šagan]* = *[šik]-ka-t[u]*, *[šap]-pa-t[u] Diri* V 256–7 (*CAD* Š/1, p. 477); cf. *Hh* X 103-4 These equations suggest that the *bur.šagan* was a vessel shaped like wine jar (*šappatu*) or an oil flask (*šikkatu*), i.e. narrow of neck and bulbous of body. It was typically made of stone (for three instances of *{na₄*bur.šagan} in administrative documents see *PSD* B, p. 183). According to *Lugale* 599, where *{na₄*bur.šagan} is also translated *pu-u₂-ru šik-ka-tum*, this stone was *{na₄*mar.hu.ša} = *marhušû*, commonly rendered ‘marcasite’, and the vessel was used for filtration of water, oil or wine (see [RN101: 220], and my note on p. 222 of that volume). The verb at the end of l. 30 has caused difficulty in the past. The correspondence with gid in Inanna’s Descent 233 // 260 makes *šadādu*, ‘to pull, draw’, the obvious derivation, though von Soden read *naddāta* ([LS304: 234]: ‘ist nicht behängt’; followed by [SladekPhD1974: 209]). I assume that the verb matches *gada bur₂* in BN 203 and so conveys not the shape of the breast or the bowl (‘drawn out’) but the drawing over the breast of a garment (so already Heidel; for the phrase *šidda/ṣubāta šadādu* see *CAD* Š/1, p. 22). Most recent translations have lost sight of the reference of the simile, which applies to the breast and not the draping. Speiser already saw the point, translating ‘her cruse-shaped breasts are not wrapped in cloth’. Ereškigal’s breasts, the clothing rent from them in mourning, are seen hanging pale and pendulous like twin flasks of marcasite.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 202); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 49

```
NinNA3a i 29. bu-da-ša₂ e[l-le-e-t]a ul kut-tu-ma
NinNA1 i 29. bu-da-a-ša₂ el-le-e-tu₄ ṣu-ba-a-t[u x x x x]
BabNB2 i 6'. [x x x x x x x x x x x x] kut-tu-mu
```

30

- **N:** irassa | kī pūr (|) šappati | lā šaddat
- **T:** her breast, uncovered, (is) like a jar of stone.’
- **L:** *irassa* ← irtu I “breast, chest of human, deity”; *kī* ← kī I “like”; *pūr* ← pūru I “(stone) bowl MA, M/jB”; *šappati* ← šappatu I “(a pottery vessel) OB(Alal.), M/NA, j/NB for wine, vinegar”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *šaddat* ← šadādu I “to drag”

- **Note:** See [RN602: 423]: “30, 50: Dem Kommentar entgehen wie schon den früheren Übersetzungen das *tertium comparationis* und der Sinn des Vergleichs. Dieser bezieht sich auf die typische Lederumhüllung des Ölgefäßes *{dug*šagan}. Wir erhalten einen kunstvollen Vergleich mit zwei Vergleichspunkten: die weibliche Brust ist wie der Gefaßkörper und die Brustbekleidung wie die Gefaßurnhüllung (vgl. *Bildersprache* S. 68 f. Nr. 33). Zu übersetzen ist: ‚Ihre Brust ist [nich]t wie ein Ölgefäß angezogen‘.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 203); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 50

```
NinNA3a ii 1. [x x x x x x x x x x šad-da-a]t₂
NinNA1 i 30. i-rat-sa ki-i pu-ri šap-pa-ti [x x x x]
BabNB2 i 7'. [x x x x x x x x x l]a šad-da-at
```

31

- **N:** [enkīdu | ana erṣeti] | urrad
- **T:** [Enkidu,] descending [to the Netherworld,]
- **L:** *[enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti]* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *urrad* ← warādu I “to go down”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 901]: “31-2. These lines represent an expansion of the original Sumerian, at least as it is given in MSS HAA (BN 206).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 204)

```
NinNA3b ii 2a. [x x x x x x x x x ( : )]
BabNB2 i 8'. [{d}en-ki-du₃ a-na KI-ti₃] ur-rad
```

32

- **N:** [ana aširti (|) gilgāme]š | ul išdud
- **T:** paid no heed [to the instructions of Gilgameš:]
- **L:** *[ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *aširti* ← aširtu I; *gilgāme]š* ← Gilgameš I; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *išdud* ← šadādu I “to drag”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 206); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 12

```
NinNA3b ii 2b. [x x x x x x x x x x iš-d]u-ud
BabNB2 i 9'. [a-na a-ši-ir-ti {d}GIŠ-gim₂-ma]š ul iš-du-ud
```

33

- **N:** ṣ[ubāta | zakâ] | ittalbiš
- **T:** he dressed himself in [a clean garment,]

- **L:** *ṣ[ubāta* ← ṣubātu I “textile, garment”; *zakâ]* ← zakû I “f. *zakūtu(m)* (NB *cf. zakītu*)”; *ittalbiš* ← labāšu I “to clothe o.s.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 207); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 13

```
NinNA3b ii 3. [x x x x x x it-tal]-biš
NinNA4a 1'. ṣ[u-ba-ta x x x x x x]
BabNB2 i 10'. [ṣu-ba-ta za-ka-a] it-tal-biš
```

34

- **N:** kīma | ub[ārū-ma] | uʾaddûšu
- **T:** they identified him as a stranger.
- **L:** *kīma* ← kīma I “like”; *ub[ārū-ma]* ← ubāru I “~ (resident) alien”; *uʾaddûšu* ← wadû I “to know”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 208); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 14

```
NinNA3b ii 4. [x x x x x x u₂-ad-d]u-šu₂
NinNA4a 2'. ki-ma u₂-b[a-ru-ma x x x x]
BabNB2 i 11'. [x x x x x x] u₂-ad-du-šu₂
```

35

- **N:** šaman (|) pūri | ṭ[āba] | ittapšiš
- **T:** He anointed himself with sweet oil from the flask,
- **L:** *šaman* ← šamnu I “oil”; *pūri* ← pūru I “(stone) bowl MA, M/jB”; *ṭ[āba]* ← ṭābu I “good”; *ittapšiš* ← pašāšu I “to anoint”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 209); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 15

```
NinNA3b ii 5. [x x x x x x x it-tap]-ši-iš
NinNA4a 3'. ša-man pu-ri ṭ[a-a-ba x x x x]
BabNB2 i 12'. [x x x x x x x] it-tap-ši-iš
```

36

- **N:** ana irīš[īšu] | iptahrūšu
- **T:** at the smell [of it] they gathered around him.
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *irīš[īšu]* ← erīšu I “scent, fragrance Bab. of person, meal, water, house”; *iptahrūšu* ← pahāru II “to gather”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 210); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 16

```
NinNA3b ii 6. [x x x x x x ip-ta]h-ru-šu
NinNA4a 4'. a-na i-ri-š[i-šu x x x x]
BabNB2 i 13'. [x x x x x x x x x] ip-tah-ru-šu₂
```

37

- **N:** tilpāna | a[na erṣeti] | issuk-ma
- **T:** He hurled a throwstick at [the Netherworld] and
- **L:** *tilpāna* ← tilpānu I “f. bow Bab. as weapon”; *a[na* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti]* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *issuk-ma* ← nasāku I “to throw (down)”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 211); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 17

```
NinNA3b ii 7a. [til-pa-na a-na KI-ti₃ is-suk-ma]
NinNA4a 5'. til-pa-na a-[na x x x x x]
BabNB2 i 14'. [x x x x x x x] is-suk-ma
```

37a

- **N:** eṭemmū | ītarrū
- **T:** the shades trembled,
- **L:** *eṭemmū* ← eṭemmu I “ghost (of dead person) receiving libations, offerings”; *ītarrū* ← arāru III “to be convulsed Bab.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 211)

```
NinNA3b ii 7b. [e-ṭem-mu] e-tar-ru
NinNA4a 6'. e-ṭem-mu [e-tar-ru]
```

38

- **N:** ša ina tilpāni | [mahṣū] | iltamûšu
- **T:** those [struck] by the throwstick surrounded him.
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *tilpāni* ← tilpānu I “f. bow Bab. as weapon”; *[mahṣū]* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”; *iltamûšu* ← lawû II “to surround”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 212); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 18

```
NinNA3b ii 8. [x x x x x x il-t]a-mu-šu₂
NinNA4a 7'. ša i-na til-pa-ni [mah-ṣu x x x x]
BabNB2 i 15'. [x x x x x x x] il-ta-mu-šu₂
```

39

- **N:** šabbiṭa | ina qāt[īšu | i]ššī-ma
- **T:** He carried a staff in [his] hand and
- **L:** *šabbiṭa* ← šabbiṭu I “staff, sceptre jB”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *qāt[īšu* ← qātu I “f.”; *i]ššī-ma* ← našû II “to lift, carry”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 213); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 19

```
NinNA3b ii 9a. [x x x x x x ( : )]
NinNA4a 8'a. šab-bi-ṭa ina qa-t[i-šu ( : )]
BabNB2 i 16'. [x x x x x x i]š-ši-ma
```

40

- **N:** [eṭemmū] | ītarrū
- **T:** [the shades] trembled.
- **L:** *[eṭemmū]* ← eṭemmu I “ghost (of dead person) receiving libations, offerings”; *ītarrū* ← arāru III “to be convulsed Bab.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 213-214); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 20

```
NinNA3b ii 9b. [e-ṭem-mu e]-tar-ru
NinNA4a 8'b. [x x x x x x]
BabNB2 i 17'. [e-ṭem-mu] e-ar#-ru?#-ru?#
```

41

- **N:** šēnī | an[a šēpīšu | išēn]
- **T:** [He wore] sandals on [his feet,]
- **L:** *šēnī* ← šēnu I “f.”; *an[a* ← ana I “(*aš-š...* etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n...*”; *šēpīšu* ← šēpu I “f., often du.”; *išēn]* ← šênu I “to put on (shoes) jB”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 215); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 21

```
NinNA4a 9'. še-e-ni a-n[a x x x x x]
```

42

- **N:** rigma | [ina erṣeti | ištakan]
- **T:** [he made] a noise [in the Netherworld.]
- **L:** *rigma* ← rigmu I “pl. f. voice, cry, noise voice of deity, human”; *[ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *ištakan]* ← šakānu I “to put, place, lay down”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 216); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 22

```
NinNA4a 10'. ri-ig-ma [ina KI-ti₃ iš-ta-kan]
```

43

- **N:** aššass[u | ša irāmu | ittašiq]
- **T:** [He kissed] the wife [he loved,]
- **L:** *aššass[u* ← aššatu I “wife”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *irāmu* ← râmu II “to love”; *ittašiq]* ← našāqu I “to kiss”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 217); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 23

```
NinNA4a 11'. aš₂-šat-s[u ša i-ra(m)-mu it-ta-šiq]
```

44

- **N:** [a]šš[assu | ša] izēr[u | imtahaṣ]
- **T:** [he struck the] wife he hated,
- **L:** *[a]šš[assu* ← aššatu I “wife”; *ša]* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *izēr[u* ← zêru I “to dislike, hate”; *imtahaṣ]* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 218); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 24

```
NinNA3a ii 13. [x x x x] i-ze-r[u im-ta-haṣ]
NinNA4a 12'. [a]š₂-š[at-su ša x x x x x x]
```

45

- **N:** m[ārāšu | š]a irāmu! | it[tašiq]
- **T:** he [kissed the] son he loved,
- **L:** *m[ārāšu* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *š]a* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *irāmu!* ← râmu II “to love”; *it[tašiq]* ← našāqu I “to kiss”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 219); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 25

```
NinNA3a ii 14. m[a-ra-šu š]a i-ram-mu i[t-ta-šiq]
```

46

- **N:** mār[āšu | š]a izēru | imt[ahaṣ]
- **T:** he [struck the] son he hated,
- **L:** *mār[āšu* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *š]a* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *izēru* ← zêru I “to dislike, hate”; *imt[ahaṣ]* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 220); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 26

```
NinNA3a ii 15. ma-r[a-šu š]a i-ze-ru im-t[a-haṣ]
```

47

- **N:** tazz[im]ti | erṣeti | iṣṣabassu
- **T:** the outcry of the Netherworld seized him!
- **L:** *tazz[im]ti* ← tazzimtu I “? complaint Bab., OA”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣṣabassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 221); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 27

```
NinNA3a ii 16. ta-z[i-im]-ti KI-ti₃ iṣ-ṣa-bat-su#
```

48

- **N:** ša ṣallat | [ša ṣa]llat | ummi (|) ninazu | ša ṣall[at]
- **T:** The one who lies, the one who lies, the mother of Ninazu who lies,
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ṣallat* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”; *[ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ṣa]llat* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”; *ummi* ← ummu I “f. mother”; *ninazu* ← Ninazu I; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ṣall[at]* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 901]: “48-54. These lines are absent from the Nippur recension of the Sumerian poem, though the last three survive at two appropriate points later in the narrative (BN 227-9, 235-7). The Mê-Turan recension offers a parallel but is not an exact match (BN 221a-g, MS pp). Evidently the Akkadian version is based on some other, similarly divergent edition of the Sumerian text.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 28

```
NinNA3a ii 17. ša ṣal-lat [ša₂ ṣa]l-lat um-mu {d}nin-a-zu ša₂ ṣal-l[at]
```

49

- **N:** būdāša | ellēti | ṣubāta | ul kuttumā
- **T:** her gleaming shoulders were not draped in a garment,
- **L:** *būdāša* ← būdu II “f. shoulder OAkk, Bab. of human beings”; *ellēti* ← ellu I “pure”; *ṣubāta* ← ṣubātu I “textile, garment”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *kuttumā* ← katāmu I “to cover”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 29

```
NinNA3a ii 18. bu-da-[ša₂ e]l-le-e-ti ṣu-ba-ta ul kut-tu-ma#
```

50

- **N:** irassa | kīma pūr (|) šikkati | ul šaddat
- **T:** her breast, uncovered, (was) like a flask of stone.
- **L:** *irassa* ← irtu I “breast, chest of human, deity”; *kīma* ← kīma I “like”; *pūr* ← pūru I “(stone) bowl MA, M/jB”; *šikkati* ← šikkatu I “flask OA, O/jB often for oil”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *šaddat* ← šadādu I “to drag”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 30

```
NinNA3a ii 19. i-rat-s[a k]i-ma pu-ur šik-ka-ti ul šad-d[a-a]t₂
```

51

- **N:** inūš[ū-ma | e]nkīdu | ultu erṣeti | ana e[lât]u?
- **T:** Then Enkidu (did not come up) from the Netherworld to the (world) above.
- **L:** *inūš[ū-ma* ← inūšu I “at that time, then OAkk, Bab. esp. in main clause after *inu(ma)*,...”; *e]nkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ultu* ← ištu I “from, out of”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *e[lât]u?* ← elû III “to go up, arise”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “51. As this line stands this line has no obvious verb, unless one emends the first word to *i-nu-q[a!]*, ‘he wailed’ ([RN272]). However, in this tablet verbs fall at the ends of clauses. It is better to assume that the end of the line is defective. The newly recovered Mê-Turan version of Bilgames and the Netherworld supports for this idea, reading at this point (BN 221b, MS pp): *šubur.ra.a.ni {d*en.ki.du$_{10}$.<<ra>> kur.ta nu.mu.un.e$_3$.de}.”
- **Parallels:** L I.4 SB "XII" 55

```
NinNA3a ii 20. i-nu-š[u-ma {d}+e]n-ki-du₃ ul-tu KI-ti₃ a-na e-[la-t]u₂?
```

52

- **N:** namt[ar | ul iṣbas]su | asakku | ul iṣbassu | erṣe[tu | iṣbass]u
- **T:** Namtar [did not] seize him, Asakku did not seize him, the Netherworld [seized] him!
- **L:** *namt[ar* ← Namtar I; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbas]su* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *asakku* ← asakku I “(an evil demon) O/jB”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣe[tu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbass]u* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 60; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 68; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 76

```
NinNA3a ii 21. {d}nam-t[ar ul iṣ-ba]t-su a-sak-ku ul iṣ-bat-su KI-t[i₃ DAB-s]u
```

53

- **N:** rāb[iṣ(u) | nergal | l]ā pādû | ul iṣbassu | erṣet[u | iṣbass]u

- **T:** The pitiless sheriff [of Nergal] did not seize him, the Netherworld [seized] him!
- **L:** *rāb[iṣ(u)* ← rābiṣu I “(an official, liter. lurker) OA bailiff, of palace, of individual”; *nergal* ← Nergal I; *l]ā* ← lā I “not, no”; *pādû* ← pādû I “forgiving M/jB(lit.) in *lā p.* relentless, merciless of deity, king,...”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣet[u* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbass]u* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “53 // 61 // 69 // 77. With the joining of N 2696 to MSY of the Sumerian poem and the collation of MS AA, the phrase *lā pādû* can now be seen to be the counterpart of two Sumerian epithets, *sag šu.nu.ba* (BN 228, MSS YAA) and *sag šu.nu.du₇* (BN 237, MSS HTT). The former epithet became a divine name in its own right, for in *An* V 108 *{d*sag.šu.nu.ba} appears as one of the four counsellors of Baba of Girsu (ed. [RN388: 178], where other references are also cited).” [RN2813xs: 281]: “It is likely that the Akkadian compiler re-interpreted the Sumerian *saĝ šu.nu.du₇* as *lā pādû* without understanding the Sumerian text, and because this translation was the only solution that made sense to him.”
- **Parallels:** L I.4 SB "XII" 61; L I.4 SB "XII" 69; L I.4 SB "XII" 77

```
NinNA3a ii 22. ra-b[i-iṣ {d}U.GUR l]a pa-du-u₂ ul iṣ-bat-su KI-t[i₃ DAB-s]u
```

54

- **N:** ašar | t[āhāz (|) z]ikarī | ul imqut | erṣetu | iṣbassu
- **T:** He did not fall where men [do battle,] the Netherworld seized him!
- **L:** *ašar* ← ašru III “pl. m. & f., place, site”; *t[āhāz* ← tāhāzu I “pl. f. battle”; *z]ikarī* ← zikaru I “male, virile stat. is manly”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *imqut* ← maqātu I “to fall”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** L I.4 SB "XII" 62; L I.4 SB "XII" 70; L I.4 SB "XII" 78

```
NinNA3a ii 23. a-šar t[a-ha-az z]i-ka-ri ul im-qut KI-ti₃ D[AB-s]u
```

55

- **N:** inūš[ū-ma | šarr]u | mār (|) ninsun | ana ardīšu | enkīdu | ibakki
- **T:** Then [the] king, son of Ninsun, weeping for his servant, Enkidu,
- **L:** *inūš[ū-ma* ← inūšu I “at that time, then OAkk, Bab. esp. in main clause after *inu(ma)*,...”; *šarr]u* ← šarru I “pl. *šarrū*, *šarrānu* king”; *mār* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *ninsun* ← Ninsun I; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ardīšu* ← ardu I “slave, servant”; *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ibakki* ← bakû I “to weep”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “55. The Mê-Turan tablet also offers a partial Sumerian counterpart to this line (BN 221c, MS pp): *lugal.e i.lu mu.un.na.be₂ e[r₂ gi]g še$_x$(|A.IGI|).še$_x$(|A.IGI|)*. This new evidence allows the sign before *mār Ninsun* to be read correctly for the first time. At the beginning of the line it is also possible to read *i-nu-u[q-ma*, ‘he wailed’.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 222); L I.4 SB "XII" 51

```
NinNA3a ii 24. i-nu#-š[u-ma LUG]AL DUMU {d}nin-sun₂ ana IR₃-šu₂ {d}+en-ki-du₃ i-
```

56

- **N:** ana ēkur | bīt (|) ellil | ēdiššīšu | ittalak
- **T:** went off alone to Ekur, the house of Enlil:
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ēkur* ← Ēkur I; *bīt* ← bītu I “m.”; *ellil* ← Ellil I “”; *ēdiššīšu* ← ēdiššī- I “(+ *-šu/ka* etc.) he/you (etc.) alone Bab. (*cf.* GAG §67f)”; *ittalak* ← alāku I “to go”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 223); L I.4 SB "XII" 64; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 72

```
NinNA3a ii 25. a-na e₂!#.[kur] E₂# {d}en-lil₂ e-diš-ši-šu₂ it-ta-lak
```

57

- **N:** abu | [elli]l | ūma | pukku (|) ana erṣeti | imqutannī-ma
- **T:** ‘O Father [Enlil], today the ball fell into the Netherworld,
- **L:** *abu* ← abu I “father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*”; *[elli]l* ← Ellil I “”; *ūma* ← ūmu I “pl. m. & f. day”; *pukku* ← pukku I “(a wooden ring or ball)? O/jB, used in game with *mekkû*”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *imqutannī-ma* ← maqātu I “to fall”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 225); L I.4 SB "XII" 4; L I.4 SB "XII" 65; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 73

```
NinNA3a ii 26. a-bu [{d}+en-li]l₂ U₄ pu-uk-ku a-na KI-ti₃ im-qut-an-ni-ma#
```

58

- **N:** mikkê | ana erṣeti | imqutannī-ma
- **T:** my mallet fell into the Netherworld!
- **L:** *mikkê* ← mekkû I “O/jB”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *imqutannī-ma* ← maqātu I “to fall”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 225); L I.4 SB "XII" 5; L I.4 SB "XII" 66; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 74

```
NinNA3a ii 27. mi-ik#-ke#-e a-na KI-ti₃ im-qut-an-ni-ma
```

59

- **N:** enkīdu | ša ana šūlîš[unu | urdu? | erṣetu | iṣbassu]
- **T:** Enkidu, who [went *down*] to bring [them up, the Netherworld seized him!]

- **L:** *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *šūlîš[unu* ← elû III “to go up, arise”; *urdu?* ← warādu I “to go down”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu]* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “59 // 67 // 75. The word provisionally restored as *ūrdu* renders the problematical Sumerian *i.gi₄*-(n) (BN 226 // 234). The latter can hardly be the modal particle *i₃.ge₄.en* discussed by [Wilcke_1968_Adverb: 239–40]. Perhaps it stands for *i₃.ĝen*, ‘he went’, though strictly speaking the opening consonants of *gi₄* and *ĝen* are different.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 226); L I.4 SB "XII" 67; L I.4 SB "XII" 75

```
NinNA3b iii 1. {d}+en-ki-du₃ ša a-na šu-li-i-š[u-nu ur-du? KI-ti₃ DAB-su]
```

60

- **N:** namtar | ul iṣbassu | asakku | ul iṣbassu | erṣetu | iṣbassu
- **T:** Namtar did not seize him, Asakku did not seize him, the Netherworld seized him!
- **L:** *namtar* ← Namtar I; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *asakku* ← asakku I “(an evil demon) O/jB”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 227); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 52; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 68; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 76

```
NinNA3b iii 2. {d}nam-tar ul iṣ-bat-su AZAG ul i[ṣ-bat-su KI-ti₃ DAB-su]
AssaNA1 iii 1–2. [x x x x i]ṣ-bat-su a-sak-ku ul iṣ-bat-su | ($___$) KI-ti₃ DAB-
```

61

- **N:** rābiṣ(u) | nergal | lā pādû | ul iṣbassu | erṣetu | iṣbassu
- **T:** The pitiless sheriff of Nergal did not seize him, the Netherworld seized him!
- **L:** *rābiṣ(u)* ← rābiṣu I “(an official, liter. lurker) OA bailiff, of palace, of individual”; *nergal* ← Nergal I; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *pādû* ← pādû I “forgiving M/jB(lit.) in *lā p.* relentless, merciless of deity, king,...”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “61-2 // 77-8. In the order of these lines the Akkadian translation follows Sumerian MSS Y, TT and pp; the majority of Nippur sources (MSS H,W, AA, BB, GG,JJ and UU) have them transposed.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 229); L I.4 SB "XII" 53; L I.4 SB "XII" 69; L I.4 SB "XII" 77

```
NinNA3b iii 3. ra-bi-iṣ {d}U.GUR la pa-du-u ul iṣ-b[at-su x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 3–4. [x x x {d}U.GU]R la pa-du-u ul iṣ-bat-su | ($___$) KI-ti₃ DAB-s
```

62

- **N:** [ašar | tāhā]z (|) zikarī | ul imqut | erṣetu | iṣbassu
- **T:** He did not fall where men do battle, the Netherworld seized him!'
- **L:** *[ašar* ← ašru III “pl. m. & f., place, site”; *tāhā]z* ← tāhāzu I “pl. f. battle”; *zikarī* ← zikaru I “male, virile stat. is manly”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *imqut* ← maqātu I “to fall”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 228); L I.4 SB "XII" 54; L I.4 SB "XII" 70; L I.4 SB "XII" 78

```
NinNA3b iii 4. a-šar ta-ha-az zi-ka-ri u[l x x x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 5. [x x ta-ha]-az zi-ka-ri ul im-qut KI-ti₃ DAB-su
```

63

- **N:** abu | ellil | amāta | ul īpulšu
- **T:** Father Enlil answered him not a word.
- **L:** *abu* ← abu I “father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*”; *ellil* ← Ellil I “”; *amāta* ← awātu I “word”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *īpulšu* ← apālu I “to pay”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 230)

```
NinNA3b iii 5a. a-bu {d}+en-lil₂ a-mat ul e-pu-u[l-šu₂ ( : )]
AssaNA1 iii 6. [x x {d}+en-l]il₂ a-mat ul i-pu-ul-šu₂
```

64

- **N:** [ana ūri | bīt (|) sîn | (ēdiššīšu?)] | ittalak
- **T:** He went off [(alone?) to Ur, the house of Sîn:]
- **L:** *[ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ūri* ← Ur I; *bīt* ← bītu I “m.”; *sîn* ← Sîn I “the moon(-god) Bab., M/NA”; *(ēdiššīšu?)]* ← ēdiššī- I “(+ *-šu/ka* etc.) he/you (etc.) alone Bab. (*cf.* GAG §67f)”; *ittalak* ← alāku I “to go”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 231)

```
NinNA3b iii 5b. [x x x x x x x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 7. [x x x x x x x x x x] it-tal-lak
```

65

- **N:** abu | sîn | ūma | pukku (|) ana erṣeti | imqutanni
- **T:** ‘O Father Sîn, today the ball fell into the Netherworld,

- **L:** *abu* ← abu I “father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*"; *sîn* ← Sîn I “the moon(-god) Bab., M/NA”; *ūma* ← ūmu I “pl. m. & f. day”; *pukku* ← pukku I “(a wooden ring or ball)? O/jB, used in game with *mekkû*"; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *imqutanni* ← maqātu I “to fall”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 233); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 4; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 57; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 73

```
NinNA3b iii 6. a-bu {d}30 U₄ pu-uk-ku [x x x x x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 8. [x x x x x x x] a#-na KI-ti₃ im-qut-an-ni
```

66

- **N:** mikkê | [ana erṣeti] | imqutanni
- **T:** my mallet fell [into the Netherworld]!
- **L:** *mikkê* ← mekkû I “O/jB”; *[ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *erṣeti]* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *imqutanni* ← maqātu I “to fall”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 233); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 5; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 58; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 74

```
NinNA3b iii 7. mi-ik-ke-e [x x x x x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 9. [x x x x a-na KI-ti₃] im-qut-an-ni
```

67

- **N:** enkīdu | ša ana šūlîš[unu | urdu? | erṣetu | iṣbassu]
- **T:** Enkidu, who [went *down*] to bring [them up], the Netherworld seized him!
- **L:** *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *šūlîš[unu* ← elû III “to go up, arise”; *urdu?* ← warādu I “to go down”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu]* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 234); L I.4 SB "XII" 59; L I.4 SB "XII" 75

```
NinNA3b iii 8. {d}+en-ki-du₃ ša₂ a-na šu-le-e-š[u?-nu x x x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 10. [x x x x x x x x x x x ur-d]u? KI-ti₃ DAB-su
```

68

- **N:** namtar | ul iṣbassu | asakku | ul iṣbassu (|) erṣetu | iṣbassu
- **T:** Namtar did not seize him, Asakku did not seize him, the Netherworld seized him!

- **L:** *namtar* ← Namtar I; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *asakku* ← asakku I “(an evil demon) O/jB”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 235); L I.4 SB "XII" 52; L I.4 SB "XII" 60; L I.4 SB "XII" 76

```
NinNA3b iii 9. {d}nam-tar ul iṣ-bat-su AZA[G x x x x x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 11. [x x x x x x x a]-sak#-ku ul# iṣ#-[bat]-su# KI#-ti₃ DAB-su
```

69

- **N:** rābiṣ(u) | nergal | lā pād[û | ul iṣbass]u | erṣetu | iṣbassu
- **T:** The pitiless sheriff of Nergal [did not seize] him, the Netherworld seized him!
- **L:** *rābiṣ(u)* ← rābiṣu I “(an official, liter. lurker) OA bailiff, of palace, of individual”; *nergal* ← Nergal I; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *pād[û* ← pādû I “forgiving M/jB(lit.) in *lā p.* relentless, merciless of deity, king,...”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbass]u* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 237); L I.4 SB "XII" 53; L I.4 SB "XII" 61; L I.4 SB "XII" 77

```
NinNA3b iii 10. ra-bi-iṣ {d}U#.GUR# la# pa#-d[u-u x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 12. [x x x x x x x x x x ul iṣ-bat-s]u KIMIN
```

70

- **N:** ašar | [tāhāz (|) zikarī | u]l imqut | erṣetu | iṣbassu
- **T:** [He did n]ot fall [where men do battle], the Netherworld seized him!'
- **L:** *ašar* ← ašru III “pl. m. & f., place, site”; *[tāhāz* ← tāhāzu I “pl. f. battle”; *zikarī* ← zikaru I “male, virile stat. is manly”; *u]l* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *imqut* ← maqātu I “to fall”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 236); L I.4 SB "XII" 54; L I.4 SB "XII" 62; L I.4 SB "XII" 78

```
NinNA3b iii 11. a#-šar# [ta-ha-az zi-ka-ri x x x x x x x]
AssaNA1 iii 13. [x x x x x x x x u]l im-qut KIMIN
```

71

- **N:** a[bu | sîn | amāta | ul īpulšu]
- **T:** Father [Sin answered him not a word.]

- **L:** *a[bu* ← abu I “father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*″; *sîn* ← Sîn I “the moon(-god) Bab., M/NA″; *amāta* ← awātu I “word″; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause″; *īpulšu]* ← apālu I “to pay″

```
BabNB2 ii 1'. a#-[bu x x x x x x x x x]
```

72

- **N:** a[na erīdu | bīt (|) ēa | (ēdiššīšu) | ittallak]
- **T:** [He went off (alone)] to [Eridu, the house of Ea:]
- **L:** *a[na* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...″; *erīdu* ← Eridu I; *bīt* ← bītu I “m.″; *ēa* ← Ea I; *(ēdiššīšu)* ← ēdiššī- I “(+ *-šu/ka* etc.) he/you (etc.) alone Bab. (*cf.* GAG §67f)″; *ittallak]* ← alāku I “to go″
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 56; L I.4 SB "XII" 64

```
BabNB2 ii 2'. a-[na eri-du10{ki} E2 {d}e2-a (e-diš-ši-šu2) it-tal-lak]
```

73

- **N:** a[bu | ea | ūma | pukku | ana erṣeti | imqutanni]
- **T:** ‘O [Father Ea, today the ball fell into the Netherworld,]
- **L:** *a[bu* ← abu I “father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*″; *ea* ← Ea I; *ūma* ← ūmu I “pl. m. & f. day″; *pukku* ← pukku I “(a wooden ring or ball)? O/jB, used in game with *mekkû*″; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...″; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land″; *imqutanni]* ← maqātu I “to fall″
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 4; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 57; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 65

```
BabNB2 ii 3'. a-[bu {d}e2-a U4 pu-uk-ku a-na KI-ti3 im-qut-an-ni]
```

74

- **N:** mik[kê | ana erṣeti | imqutanni]
- **T:** [My] mallet [fell into the Netherworld,]
- **L:** *mik[kê* ← mekkû I “O/jB″; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...″; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land″; *imqutanni]* ← maqātu I “to fall″
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 5; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 58; cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 66

```
BabNB2 ii 4'. me-ek-[ke-e a-na KI-ti3 im-qut-an-ni]
```

75

- **N:** enkīd[u | ša ana šūlîšunu | urdu? | erṣeti | iṣbassu]

- **T:** Enkidu, [who went *down* to bring them up, the Netherworld seized him!]
- **L:** *enkīd[u* ← Enkidu I; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *šūlîšunu* ← elû III “to go up, arise”; *urdu?* ← warādu I “to go down”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu]* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** L I.4 SB "XII" 59; L I.4 SB "XII" 67

```
BabNB2 ii 5'. {d}+en-ki-d[u₃ ša₂ a-na šu-li-i-šu-nu ur-du KI-ti₃ DAB-su]
```

76

- **N:** namtar | u[l iṣbassu | asakku | ul iṣbassu | erṣetu | iṣbassu]
- **T:** Namtar did not [seize him, Asakku did not seize him, the Netherworld seized him!]
- **L:** *namtar* ← Namtar I; *u[l* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *asakku* ← asakku I “(an evil demon) O/jB”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu]* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** L I.4 SB "XII" 52; L I.4 SB "XII" 60; L I.4 SB "XII" 68

```
NinNA3a iii 17. {d#}nam#-[tar x x x x x x x x x x x x x x x]
BabNB2 ii 6'. {d}nam-tar u[l iṣ-bat-su a-sak-ku ul iṣ-bat-su KI-ti₃ DAB-su]
```

77

- **N:** rābiṣ(u) | nergal | lā pād[û | ul iṣbassu | erṣetu | iṣbassu]
- **T:** The pitiless sheriff of Nergal [did not seize him, the Netherworld seized him!]
- **L:** *rābiṣ(u)* ← rābiṣu I “(an official, liter. lurker) OA bailiff, of palace, of individual”; *nergal* ← Nergal I; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *pād[û* ← pādû I “forgiving M/jB(lit.) in *lā p.* relentless, merciless of deity, king,...”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *iṣbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu]* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Parallels:** L I.4 SB "XII" 53; L I.4 SB "XII" 61; L I.4 SB "XII" 69

```
NinNA3a iii 18. ra-bi-iṣ {d}U.GUR la# pa#-du#-[u ul iṣ-bat-su KI-ti₃ DAB-su]
BabNB2 ii 7'. ra-bi-ṣu {d#}[U.GUR x x x x x x x x x x x]
```

78

- **N:** ašar | tāhāz (|) zik[arī | ul imqut | erṣetu | iṣbassu]
- **T:** [He did not fall] where men do battle, [the Netherworld seized him!]’
- **L:** *ašar* ← ašru III “pl. m. & f., place, site”; *tāhāz* ← tāhāzu I “pl. f. battle”; *zik[arī* ← zikaru I “male, virile stat. is manly”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *imqut* ← maqātu I “to fall”; *erṣetu* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iṣbassu]* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”

- **Parallels:** L I.4 SB "XII" 54; L I.4 SB "XII" 62; L I.4 SB "XII" 78

```
NinNA3a iii 19. a-šar ta-ha-az zi-k[a-ri ul im-qut KI-ti₃ DAB-su]
BabNB2 ii 8'. a-šar ta-ha-[az x x x x x x x x x]
```

79

- **N:** abu | ēa | i[na? ...]
- **T:** Father Ea [*helped him*] in [*this matter*,]
- **L:** *abu* ← abu I "father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*"; *ēa* ← Ea I; *i[na?* ← ina I "(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 238)

```
NinNA3a iii 20. a-bu {d}e₂-a# [x x x x x x x x (x)]
BabNB2 ii 9'. a-bi {d}e₂-a# i[na? x x x x x x x (x)]
```

80

- **N:** ana qarrādi | e[ṭli | šamaš | iqabbi]
- **T:** [he spoke] to Young Hero [Šamaš:]
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I "(*aš-š...* etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n...*"; *qarrādi* ← qarrādu I "pl. also *qarrādūtu* warlike"; *e[ṭli* ← eṭlu I "manly"; *šamaš* ← Šamaš I; *iqabbi]* ← qabû II "to say, speak, command"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 239)

```
NinNA3a iii 21. a-na qar-ra-di e[ṭ-li {d}UTU i-qab-bi]
BabNB2 ii 10'. a-na qar-ra-d[u x x x x x x x]
```

81

- **N:** qarrādu | eṭlu | šam[aš | mār (|) ningal | ...]
- **T:** 'O Young Hero Šamaš, [... son of Ningal,]
- **L:** *qarrādu* ← qarrādu I "pl. also *qarrādūtu* warlike"; *eṭlu* ← eṭlu I "manly"; *šam[aš* ← Šamaš I; *mār* ← māru I "son, descendant"; *ningal* ← Ningal I
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: "81. Restored after l. 85."
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 239); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 85

```
NinNA3a iii 22. qar-ra-du eṭ-lu {d}U[TU x x x x x x x]
BabNB2 ii 11'. qar-ra-du eṭ-l[u x x x x x x x x x]
```

82

- **N:** lūman | takkap (|) [erṣeti | tepette]
- **T:** *perhaps* [you can open] a chink [in the Netherworld,]
- **L:** *lūman* ← lūman I "O/jB modal adv."; *takkap* ← takkapu I "hole, window O/jB window, peephole"; *[erṣeti* ← erṣetu I "earth, land"; *tepette]* ← petû II "to open"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 240)

```
NinNA3a iii 23. lu-man tak-ka-ap [KI-ti₃ te-pet-te]
BabNB2 ii 12'. lu-man tak-ka-[ap x x x x x]
```

83

- **N:** utukku | ša en[kīdu | kī zāqīqi | ulti erṣeti | tušellâ]
- **T:** [you can bring] the shade of Enkidu [up from the Netherworld like a phantom!],
- **L:** *utukku* ← utukku I "(an evil demon)"; *ša* ← ša I "who(m), which"; *en[kīdu* ← Enkidu I; *kī* ← kī I "like"; *zāqīqi* ← zīqīqu I "wind, breeze Bab."; *ulti* ← ištu I "from, out of"; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I "earth, land"; *tušellâ]* ← elû III "to go up, arise"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: "83. For *utukku* as a near synonym *eṭemmu*, 'ghost', see, in an astrological report ([RN2049: 7]), the omen apodosis *utukki*(udug) *ḫab-lim māta*(kur) *iṣabbat*(dab){*bat*-ma} *mūtānu*(nam.úš){*meš*} *ina māti*(kur) *ibaššû*(gál){*meš*}, 'the shade of someone wronged will seize the land and there will be pestilence in the land'. The two words are also semantically related in Sumerian, for the sign *udug* is a variant of *gidim*, 'ghost', and occurs in its stead often enough to earn the value *gidim₄*."
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 241)

```
NinNA3a iii 24. u₂-tuk-ku š[a₂ {d}+en-ki-du₃ ki-i za-qi₂-qi₂ ul-tu KI-ti₃ tu-še-
BabNB2 ii 13'. ŠU-tuk-ku ša₂ {d}+en-[ki-du₃ x x x x x x x x x x x x x]
```

84

- **N:** ana am[āt | ...]
- **T:** To the word [of Ea .....]
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I "(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*..."; *am[āt* ← awātu I "word"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 241a)

```
NinNA3a iii 25. a-na a-m[at? x x x x x x x x x (x)]
BabNB2 ii 14'. a-na qi₂-bit# [x x x x x x x x x (x)]
```

85

- **N:** qarrādu | eṭlu | šamaš | mār (|) nin[gal | ...]
- **T:** The Young Hero Šamaš, [...] son of Ningal,
- **L:** *qarrādu* ← qarrādu I “pl. also *qarrādūtu* warlike”; *eṭlu* ← eṭlu I “manly”; *šamaš* ← Šamaš I; *mār* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *nin[gal* ← Ningal I
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “85. The beginning of the Sumerian counterpart of this line has now come to light on the tablet in the Schøyen Collection, SC 3361 (BN 241a, MS rr_2).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 241a); cf. L I.4 SB "XII" 81

```
NinNA3a iii 26. qar-ra-du eṭ-lu {d}UTU# DUMU# {d}nin#-[gal x x] x
```

86

- **N:** takkap (|) erṣeti | iptē-ma
- **T:** opened a chink in the Netherworld,
- **L:** *takkap* ← takkapu I “hole, window O/jB window, peephole”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *iptē-ma* ← petû II “to open”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “86. Comparison with the Sumerian shows that *lūman* is an error generated by l. 82 (cf. already *CAD* L, p. 245).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 242)

```
NinNA3a iii 27. <<lu-man>> tak-ka-ap KI-ti₃ ip-te-e-ma
```

87

- **N:** utukka | ša enkīdu | kī zaqīqi | ultu erṣeti | uštēlâ
- **T:** he brought the shade of Enkidu up from the Netherworld like a phantom.
- **L:** *utukka* ← utukku I “(an evil demon)”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *enkīdu* ← Enkidu I; *kī* ← kī I “like”; *zaqīqi* ← zīqīqu I “wind, breeze Bab.”; *ultu* ← ištu I “from, out of”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *uštēlâ* ← elû III “to go up, arise”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “87-9. The sole witness to this episode, MS G_1, is badly scuffed at this point. My readings of the last words of each of the three lines differ from those of previous commentators, but produce in each case a text that is more predictable from the Sumerian. Since the Dtt stem is not found in Babylonian I assume that *ut-ta-taš-šá-qu* (l. 88) represents *uttaššaqū* rather than *uttataššaqū*. The erroneous equivalence $kuš_2.u_3$, to become exhausted′ (BN 245) = *malāku* (l. 89) is based on the equation $ša_3.kuš_2.u_3$ = *ma-li-ku* (*MSL* XVI, p. 84, *Nabnītu* IV 196; XII, p. 118, *Lú* II ii 8-10).”

```
NinNA3a iii 28. u₂-tuk-ku ša₂ {d}+en-ki-du₃ ki-i za-qi₂-qi₂ ul-tu₂# KI#-ti₃# uš#
```

88

- **N:** innedrū-ma | uttaššaqū
- **T:** They hugged each other, kissing one another,
- **L:** *innedrū-ma* ← edēru I “to embrace, wrap o.s. round O/jB”; *uttaššaqū* ← našāqu I “to kiss”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 244)

```
NinNA3a iii 29. in-ne₂-ed#-ru#-ma ut-{+ta}taš-ša₂-qu
```

89

- **N:** imtallikū | ištana’’alū
- **T:** sharing thoughts and exchanging questions:
- **L:** *imtallikū* ← malāku II “to discuss”; *ištana’’alū* ← šâlu I “to ask”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 245)

```
NinNA3a iii 30. im-tal-li#-ku iš#-ta#-an-na-lu#
```

90

- **N:** qibâ | ibrī | qibâ | ibrī
- **T:** ‘Tell me, my friend! Tell me, my friend!
- **L:** *qibâ* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”; *ibrī* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *qibâ* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”; *ibrī* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 246)

```
NinNA3a iv 1. qi₂-ba-a ib-ri qi₂-ba-a ib-ri
```

91

- **N:** ûrti (|) erṣeti | ša tāmuru | qibâ
- **T:** Tell me the rules of the Netherworld that you saw!’
- **L:** *ûrti* ← u''urtu I “commission, command Bab. of god, king, master”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tāmuru* ← amāru I “to see”; *qibâ* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 246)

```
NinNA3a iv 2. ur-ti₃ KI-ti₃ ša₂ ta-mu-ru qi₂-ba-a
```

92

- **N:** ul aqabbâkkum | ibrī | ul aqabbâkkum
- **T:** ‘I cannot tell you, my friend, I cannot tell you!

- **L:** *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *aqabbâkkum* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”; *ibrī* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *aqabbâkkum* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902]: “92. The translation *ul aqabbâkkum* disregards the /š/ of the preformative *nu.uš-* and ignores the first-person dative infix in the verbal prefix chain: the Sumerian *nu.uš.ma.ab.be₂.en* (BN 247) can only mean ‘if only you would tell me!.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 247)

```
NinNA3a iv 3. ul a-qab-ba-ku ib-ri ul a-qab-ba-ku
```

93

- **N:** šumma ûrti (|) erṣeti | ša āmuru | aqabbīka
- **T:** if I am going to tell you the rules of the Netherworld that I saw,
- **L:** *šumma* ← šumma I “if (NB only lit.”; *ûrti* ← u''urtu I “commission, command Bab. of god, king, master”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *āmuru* ← amāru I “to see”; *aqabbīka* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 248)

```
NinNA3a iv 4. šum#-ma ur-ti₃ KI-ti₃ ša₂ a-mu-ru a-qab-bi-ka
```

94

- **N:** [att]ā | tišab | biki
- **T:** sit you down (and) weep!'
- **L:** *[att]ā* ← attā I “you (2 m. sg. pron.)”; *tišab* ← ašābu I “to sit (down)”; *biki* ← bakû I “to weep”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 249)

```
NinNA3a iv 5. [at-t]a ti-šab bi-ki
```

95

- **N:** [anāk]u | lušib-ma | lubki
- **T:** ‘[(So)] let me sit down and weep!'
- **L:** *[anāk]u* ← anāku I “I”; *lušib-ma* ← ašābu I “to sit (down)”; *lubki* ← bakû I “to weep”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 249)

```
NinNA3a iv 6. [a-na-k]u lu#-ši-ib-ma lu-ub-ki
```

96

- **N:** [ibrī? | iš]ara | ša talputū-ma | libbaka | ihdû
- **T:** ‘[*My friend*, the] penis that you handled so your heart rejoiced,
- **L:** *[ibrī?* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *iš]ara* ← išaru II “penis O/jB of man, dog etc.”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *talputū-ma* ← lapātu I “to touch, take hold of”; *libbaka* ← libbu I “inner body”; *ihdû* ← hadû III “to be joyful, rejoice”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 902–903]: “96-9. These lines have now to be interpreted in the light of MS rr, the new source for BN 250-3. In the Sumerian it transpires that there Enkidu describes the corruption not of his own body but of the corpse of a woman who had been Gilgameš’s sexual partner. The tradition that there were such women is found in the unpublished Ur III fragment IM 70101 = 6N-T 450 (see Chapter 1, fn. 16). The decomposition of her body is symbolized graphically by the decay of her genitals. The new text also shows more clearly than before how the Akkadian translator altered the thrust of the passage in translation. While evidently keeping the two lines that frame the passage he adapted BIN 251-2 freely, imposing on the text a parallelism not present in the Sumerian, and converting the third-person subject of *giš šu bi₂.in.tag.ga* (BN 250), i.e. the owner of the gal.la (BN 252-3), into the second person (*talputu*), i.e. Gilgameš. In this way the Akkadian lines appear at first glance to describe the decomposition of a both a male and a female body. It has always been suspected, however, that what Enkidu reports in the translation is the decay of his own corpse and in my view this is stil the case. Enkidu had a penis but surely no vulva. Sumerian *gal₄.la* has three common counterparts in Akkadian, *biṣṣūru* and *qallû*, both meaning ‘vulva’, and *ūru*, ‘crotch’; the last of these is attested as part of a man’s body as well as a woman’s. In this way it was open to the translator to apply both sets of parallel lines to Enkidu, and that is exactly what I assume was done. In short, the newly revealed explicitness of the Sumerian passage, as reworded in the Akkadian version, is further evidence for the often doubted sexual relationship between Gilgameš and Enkidu.” See also the interpretation by [RN2813xs: 287]: “Gilgameš, a strongly sexual hero, inquires about sex in the Netherworld, to be told by his servant Enkidu that sexuality, there, is dead. That the connotation of the reign of Ereškigal as a sexless place opens the description of list of ghosts should not come as a surprise, as the sexless nature of the Netherworld is known also from other sources as well, for instance NerEreš and IšDesc.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 250)

```
NinNA3a iv 7. [ib-ri? i-š]a₂-ra# ša₂ tal-pu-tu-ma lib₃-ba-ka ih-du-u
```

97

- **N:** [… | kī guš]ūri | labīri | kalmatu | ikkal
- **T:** grubs devour [(it) … like an] old *beam*.

- **L:** *kī* ← kī I “like”; *guš]ūri* ← gušūru I “tree-trunk, beam felled log, tree-trunk of cedar etc.”; *labīri* ← labīru I “old of objects, food, drink etc.”; *kalmatu* ← kalmatu I “insect(s), bug(s) etc. usu. coll.”; *ikkal* ← akālu I “to eat”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 903]: “97. For *kalmatu*, lit. ‘louse’, as a term for the grub of the clothes moth see the lexical entry *Ḫḫ* XIV 267: *uh.tug₂.ba* = *kal-mat ṣu-ba-ti* (*MSL* VIII/2, p. 30). For *ME* with the value *tuba*, meaning ‘cloak’, in the Sumerian line (BN 252, MS rr), see OB Proto-*Ea* (*MSL* XIV, pp. 34, 73: *{tu-ba*ME}; 128, 23: *{tu-ba*ME} = *na-al-ba-šum*).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 251)

```
NinNA3a iv 8. [(x x) ki-i gu-š]u-ri la-bi-ri kal-ma-tu e-kal
NinNA4b iv 1'. [x x x x x x x x x x x x i]k-kal
```

98

- **N:** [ibrī? | ūra | ša ta]lputū-ma | libbaka | ihdû
- **T:** [*My friend, the vagina* that you] felt so your heart rejoiced,
- **L:** *[ibrī?* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”; *ūra* ← ūru II “(nakedness, i.e.) pudenda OAkk, O/jB of man, woman”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ta]lputū-ma* ← lapātu I “to touch, take hold of”; *libbaka* ← libbu I “inner body”; *ihdû* ← hadû III “to be joyful, rejoice”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 252)

```
NinNA3a iv 9. [x x x x x ta]l-pu-tu-ma lib₃-ba-ka ih-du-u
NinNA4b iv 2'. [x x x x x x x x x lib₃-b]a-ka# ih-du-u₂
```

99

- **N:** [kī nigiṣ (|) erṣet]i | epera | mali
- **T:** it is filled with dust [like a crack in the ground.]’
- **L:** *[kī* ← kī I “like”; *nigiṣ* ← nigiṣṣu I “pl. f. crack, crevice M/jB”; *erṣet]i* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *epera* ← eperu I “earth, soil”; *mali* ← malû IV “to be(come) full”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 253)

```
NinNA3a iv 10. [x x x x x KI-t]i e-pe-ri ma-li
NinNA4b iv 3'. [x x x x x e-p]e-ra ma-li
```

100

- **N:** [šū | ūʾa] | iqbīma | [ina epri | it]tapalsih
- **T:** ‘[Woe!]’ said [he,] and threw himself prostrate [in the] dust.

- **L:** *[šū* ← šū I “he”; *ūʾa]* ← ū'a I “woe!”; *iqbīma* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”; *[ina* ← ina I “(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on”; *epri* ← eperu I “earth, soil”; *it]tapalsih* ← napalsuhu I “to fall to the ground, squat, grovel Bab.”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 903]: “100-1. This couplet combines the two different versions of the Sumerian exhibited by the Nippur sources on the one hand (MS H, at least) and MS rr on the other (BN 254). Compare two other bilingual passages: *sahar.hub.ba ba.dur₂* : *ina e-pe-ri it-ta-pal-saḫ* ([RN1745xx: 120, rev. 5-6]); *sahar.ra durun.na.eš.am₃* : *ina e-per it-ta-pal-si-ḫu* ([RN2740yy: 109, no. 27 obv. 12-13]).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 254)

```
NinNA3a iv 11. [x x x x x x x e]p-ri it-ta-pal-si-ih
NinNA4b iv 4'-5'. [šu-u₂ uʾ₃-a] iq-bi-ma | [i-na ep-ri i]t-ta-pal-si-ih
```

101

- **N:** [gilgāmeš | ūʾa] | iqbīma | [ina epr]i | ittapalsih
- **T:** ‘[Woe!]’ said [Gilgameš,] and threw himself prostrate [in the dust.]
- **L:** *[gilgāmeš* ← Gilgameš I; *ūʾa]* ← ū'a I “woe!”; *iqbīma* ← qabû II “to say, speak, command”; *[ina* ← ina I “(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on”; *epr]i* ← eperu I “earth, soil”; *ittapalsih* ← napalsuhu I “to fall to the ground, squat, grovel Bab.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 254)

```
NinNA3a iv 12. [x x x x x x x x x x ep-r]i it-ta-pal-si-ih
NinNA4b iv 6'-7'. [x x x x uʾ₃-a] iq-bi-ma | [i-na ep-ri it-t]a-pal-si-ih
AssaNA1 iv 1'. [x x x x x x x x x x x x x it-t]a-[pal-sih]
```

102

- **N:** [ša mārūšu | ištēn-ma | tāmu]r | ātamar
- **T:** ‘Did [you see the man with one son?]’ ‘I saw (him).
- **L:** *[ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *mārūšu* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *ištēn-ma* ← ištēn I “f. *išteat*, *ištiat*, *iš/ltē/īt(um)*, *iš/ltât*, NA *issēt*”; *tāmu]r* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 903]: “102. The writing *ta-mu-ru* here and in succeeding lines of MSS UKK is taken as a spelling in which the final CV sign marks the preceding syllable as stressed, *tāmúr*; for comparable spellings of long closed syllables see Chapter 9, the section on Spelling conventions sub (g). MSS GN use the regular spelling, *ta-mur* (ll. 144-52).”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 255)

```
NinNA3a iv 13. [x x x x x x x x] a-ta-mar
NinNA4b iv 8'. [x x x x x ta-mu-r]u a-ta-mar
AssaNA1 iv 2'. [x x x x x x x x x] a#-ta-mar
```

103

- **N:** [sikkatu | ina igārīšu | ret]ât-ma | [marṣiš] | ina muhhi | ibakki
- **T:** [A peg is] fixed [in his wall] and he weeps over [it bitterly.]'
- **L:** *[sikkatu* ← sikkatu I "peg, nail of wood, copper"; *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on"; *igārīšu* ← igāru I "pl. f. wall of house, garden"; *ret]ât-ma* ← retû II "to drive in, fix Bab., NA"; *[marṣiš]* ← marṣiš I "bitterly, sadly"; *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on"; *muhhi* ← muhhu I "skull"; *ibakki* ← bakû I "to weep"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 903]: "103. As Shaffer noted, the peg in the wall is a mark of ownership: 'the implication seems to be that the house has changed hands' ([shaffer1963sumerian: 149]; further [RN580: 265, fn. g]; [bauer1989schlimme: 22]). Where a house has been pledged as collateral security for a loan, such a peg can also mark the creditor's interest in his debtor's property. As the debtor weeps in the realization that the future of his household is precarious, so the father of a single son laments the lack of family to provide his shade with water."
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 256)

```
NinNA3a iv 14. [x x x x x x x x x x x x] muh#-hi# i#-bak#-ki#
NinNA4b iv 9'-10'. [{giš}GAG ina i-ga-ri-šu₂ re-t]a-at-ma | [mar-ṣi-iš i-na muh-
AssaNA1 iv 3'. [x x x x x x x x x x x x x x m]uh-hi i-bak-ki
```

104

- **N:** [ša mārūšu | šinā-ma | tāmur | ā]tamar
- **T:** '[Did you see the man with two sons?' 'I] saw (him).
- **L:** *[ša* ← ša I "who(m), which"; *mārūšu* ← māru I "son, descendant"; *šinā-ma* ← šina I; *tāmur* ← amāru I "to see"; *ā]tamar* ← amāru I "to see"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 257)

```
AssaNA1 iv 4'. [ša₂ DUMU-MEŠ-šu₂ 2-ma ta-mu-ru a]-ta-mar
```

105

- **N:** [ina šittā | libnāti | ašib-ma] | akala | ikkal
- **T:** [He sits on two bricks] eating a bread-loaf.'

- **L:** *[ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *šittā* ← šina II “two (st. constr. *šin*”; *libnāti* ← libittu I “j/NB st. constr. also *libnat* mudbrick”; *ašib-ma]* ← ašābu I “to sit (down)”; *akala* ← akalu I; *ikkal* ← akālu I “to eat”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 258)

```
AssaNA1 iv 5'. [i-na 2 SIG₄-MEŠ a-šib-ma] a#-ka-lu ik-kal
```

106

- **N:** [ša mārūšu | šalāšat-ma | tāmuru] | ātamar
- **T:** ‘[Did you see the man with three sons?]’ ‘I saw (him).
- **L:** *[ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *mārūšu* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *šalāšat-ma* ← šalāš I “st. abs.”; *tāmuru]* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 259)

```
AssaNA1 iv 6'. [ša₂ DUMU-MEŠ-šu₂ 3-ma ta-mu-ru] a-ta-mar
```

107

- **N:** [ina nādi | ša takšî] | mê | išatti
- **T:** He drinks water [from a waterskin slung on the saddle.]’
- **L:** *[ina* ← ina I “(*im-m...*, *ip-p...* etc.) in, on”; *nādi* ← nādu I “f.”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *takšî]* ← takšiu I “pl. f. (leather container) OAkk, O/jB for valuables”; *mê* ← mû I “pl. tant. water *mê kabrūtim* mass of water”; *išatti* ← šatû II “to drink”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 903]: “107. The original Sumerian line (BN 260) is now explained by [civil_feeding_1987: 47], where the meaning of *dag.si* = *dakšû* is also elucidated.” Note also [RN2813xs: 289]: “*dag-si*, loaned into Akkadian as *takšû*, is a word play with its Akkadian homophone *takšû*, “triplets” (Jerrold Cooper, personal communication) for which see CAD T 88-9 s. v. *takšû* A.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 260)

```
AssaNA1 iv 7'. [i-na na-a-di ša₂ tak₂-ši-i] A-MEŠ i-šat-ti
```

108

- **N:** [ša mārūšu | erbet-ma | tāmu]r | ātamar
- **T:** ‘Did [you see the man with four sons?]’ ‘I saw (him).
- **L:** *[ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *mārūšu* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *erbet-ma* ← erbe I “f. *erbēt*, Ass. *arbēt*”; *tāmu]r* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 261)

```
AssaNA1 iv 8'. [ša₂ DUMU-MEŠ-šu₂ 4-ma ta-mu]-ru# a-ta-mar
```

109

- **N:** [kī ša imēr (|) ṣind]āti | libbašu | hadi
- **T:** [Like the owner of a donkey]-team his heart rejoices.'
- **L:** *[kī* ← kī I "like"; *ša* ← ša I "who(m), which"; *imēr* ← imēru I "donkey *ša i.*, NA *ša i.-šu* donkey driver"; *ṣind]āti* ← ṣimdu I "pl. m. & f. binding"; *libbašu* ← libbu I "inner body"; *hadi* ← hadû II "joy Bab., esp. *bussurat/awāt/ṭēmam (ša) hadêm* ref. to good news"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 262)

```
AssaNA1 iv 9'. [ki-i ša₂ ANŠE ṣi-in-d]a-a#-ti lib₃-ba-šu₂ ha-di
```

110

- **N:** [ša mārūšu | hamšat-ma | t]āmur | ātamar
- **T:** 'Did you see [the man with five sons?]' 'I saw (him).
- **L:** *[ša* ← ša I "who(m), which"; *mārūšu* ← māru I "son, descendant"; *hamšat-ma* ← hamiš I "st. abs."; *t]āmur* ← amāru I "to see"; *ātamar* ← amāru I "to see"
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 263)

```
AssaNA1 iv 10'. [ša₂ DUMU-MEŠ-šu₂ 5-ma t]a-mu-ru a-ta-mar
```

111

- **N:** [kī ṭupšar]ri | damqi | issu | petât
- **T:** [Like a] fine [scribe] his hand is deft,
- **L:** *[kī* ← kī I "like"; *ṭupšar]ri* ← ṭupšarru I "scribe"; *damqi* ← damqu I "good"; *issu* ← idu I "pl. m. & f. arm"; *petât* ← petû II "to open"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 903]: "111. C. Wilcke has translated *a₂.ni gal₂ bi₂.in.tag₄* = *issu petât* as 'läßt er (beim Gehen) die Arme weit schwingen' ([RN696: 180]). However, the phrase seems to have some other meaning in scribal context, as we learn from Enkitalu and Enkiḫegal 112 (*PSD* A/2, p. 2): *a₂.ni gal₂ bi₂.in.tak₄ šir₃.gid₂.da nu.ub.be₂*, 'he "opened his arm", he cannot recite a "long song"'. Heidel took the phrase to mean 'his arm is bared' (also Speiser), while von Soden translated 'arbeitsbereit' (Reclam⁴). I see an 'open' arm as a more positive attribute, one that can obtain a scribe a coveted position in the palace administration. Presumably then it means a swift and nimble hand (cf. [RN580], 'son bras se remue')." See also [RN602: 423]: "Für eine positive Interpretation von *issu petât* s. auch Rez., *Bildersprache* S. 84 Nr. 70a."
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 264)

```
AssaNA1 iv 11'. [ki-i DUB.SA]R dam-qi₂ id-su pe-ta-at
```

112

- **N:** [išariš] | ana ēkalli | irrub
- **T:** he enters the palace [with ease.]’
- **L:** *[išariš]* ← išariš I “correctly, normally, *i. apālu* to answer, repay satisfactorily,...”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š...* etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n...*”; *ēkalli* ← ēkallu I “f., rarely m.”; *irrub* ← erēbu I “to enter”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 264)

```
AssaNA1 iv 12'. [i-ša₂-riš] a-na E₂.GAL KU₄-ub
```

113

- **N:** [ša mārūšu | šeššet-ma | t]āmur | ātamar
- **T:** ‘Did you see [the man with six sons?]’ ‘I saw (him).
- **L:** *[ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *mārūšu* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *šeššet-ma* ← šediš I “six”; *t]āmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 265)

```
AssaNA1 iv 13'. [ša₂ DUMU-MEŠ-šu₂ 6-ma t]a-mu-ru a-ta-mar
```

114

- **N:** [kī errēši | libbašu | hadi]
- **T:** [Like a ploughman his heart rejoices.]’
- **L:** *[kī* ← kī I “like”; *errēši* ← errēšu I “cultivator OAkk, Bab. esp. of tenant”; *libbašu* ← libbu I “inner body”; *hadi]* ← hadû II “joy Bab., esp. *bussurat/awāt/ṭēmam (ša) hadêm* ref. to good news”
- **Parallels:** (cf. Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 266)

115

- **N:** [ša mārūšu | sebet-ma | tāmur | ātamar]
- **T:** ‘[Did you see the man with seven sons?’ ‘’I saw (him).]
- **L:** *[ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *mārūšu* ← māru I “son, descendant”; *sebet-ma* ← sebe I “f. *sebet(tu)* seven, *sebet ūmim sebe mušiātim* seven days (and)...”; *tāmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar]* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Parallels:** (cf. Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 267)

116

- **N:** [kī duppussê | ilī | ina kussî | ašib … išemme]
- **T:** [Among the junior deities he sits on a throne and listens to the proceedings.]′
- **L:** *[kī* ← kī I “like”; *duppussê* ← duppussû I “younger brother j/NB(lit.), also transf. second in rank”; *ilī* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on”; *kussî* ← kussû I “f. occas. m. chair, stool, throne as piece of household furniture”; *ašib* ← ašābu I “to sit (down)”; *išemme]* ← šemû I “to hear”
- **Parallels:** (cf. Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 268)

117

- **N:** [… | tāmur | ātamar]
- **T:** ‘[Did you see the *palace eunuch?*′ ‘I saw (him).]
- **L:** *tāmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar]* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Parallels:** (cf. Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 269)

118

- **N:** kī šurinni | damqi | tub[qa] | a[hi]z
- **T:** Like a fine standard he *is propped* in the corner,
- **L:** *kī* ← kī I “like”; *šurinni* ← šurīnu I “(divine) emblem Bab., M/NA”; *damqi* ← damqu I “good”; *tub[qa]* ← tubqu I “pl. *tub(u)qātu(m)* corner, recess OAkk, Bab.”; *a[hi]z* ← ahāzu I “to take”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 903–904]: “118. The place of this line soon after the section dealing with numbers of sons leads one to compare it with BN a-e, which have in common that their subjects are childless. The presence of *tubqu* makes a correlation with *ub.dug$_4$.ga* (BN b) highly attractive. Though *šurinnu damqu* is not an exact match for *pa a.la.la hu.ru/hur.ra*, ‘a useless *alala*-stick’, a standard and a stick are at least comparable items (see further [NABU1997-97]). Since it may be assumed that palace eunuchs, like soldiers, wore some kind of uniform or standardized dress, the simile of the ‘fine standard’ perhaps draws attention to the fellow’s splendid livery. The next line represents an expansion of the original and, were it legible, it might provide a rendering nearer the Sumerian of BN b. The line asking after the palace eunuch begins the second section of Gilgameš and Enkidu’s dialogue in four of six manuscripts of the Sumerian poem (MSS FHDDFF *v*. MSS VDDD), so I assume that it comes first in the Akkadian version too. Since the preceding section is restorable line by line up to l. 116, Gilgamesh’s first query of the new section will fall at l. 117. The place of this line, MS G v 1, as Enkidu’s corresponding answer, is thus fixed by restoration at 118, confirming Thompson’s calculation from the physical shape of MS G.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 272)

```
NinNA3a v 1. ki-i šu-ri-in-ni dam-qi₂ tub₂-[qa] a?#-[hi?]-iz?#
```

119

- **N:** kī … […] …
- **T:** like …’
- **L:** *kī* ← kī I “like”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 272)

```
NinNA3a v 2. ki#-i# x x x x x x x [x x x] x
```

129

- **N:** … […]
- **T:** … […]

```
NinNA3a v 12. x [x x x x x x x x x x]
```

130

- **N:** … […]
- **T:** … […]

```
NinNA3a v 13. x [x x x x x x x x x x]
```

131

- **N:** … […]
- **T:** … […]

```
NinNA3a v 14. x [x x x x x x x x x x]
```

132

- **N:** š[a … | tāmur | ātamar]
- **T:** ‘[Did you see] the one [who … ?’ ‘I saw (him).]
- **L:** *š[a* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tāmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar]* ← amāru I “to see”

```
NinNA3a v 15. š[a₂ x x x x x x x x x x]
```

133

- **N:** a[na? …]
- **T:** *To* […]’
- **L:** *a[na?* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”

```
NinNA3a v 16. a#-[na? x x x x x x x x]
```

134

- **N:** š[a … | tāmur | ātamar]
- **T:** ‘[Did you see] the one [who…?’ ‘I saw (him).]
- **L:** *š[a* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *tāmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar]* ← amāru I “to see”

```
NinNA3a v 17. š[a₂ x x x x x x x x x x]
```

135

- **N:** a[na? …]
- **T:** *To* […]′
- **L:** *a[na?* ← ana I “(*aš-š*… etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*…”

```
NinNA3a v 18. a?#-[na? x x x x x x x x x]
```

136

- **N:** … […]
- **T:** … […]

```
NinNA3a v 19. x [x x x x x x x x x x]
```

137

- **N:** … […]
- **T:** … […]

```
NinNA3a v 20. x [x x x x x x x x x x]
```

144

- **N:** ša ina tarkulli | mahṣu | tāmur | ā[tamar]
- **T:** ‘Did you see the one who was struck by a mooring-pole?’ ‘I [saw (him).]
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*…, *ip-p*… etc.) in, on”; *tarkulli* ← tarkullu I “pl. m. & f. wooden post, pole OAkk, O/jB as mast of boat”; *mahṣu* ← mahāṣu I “to beat”; *tāmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *ā[tamar]* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 904]: “144. For *tarkullu*, not ‘mast’ but ‘mooring-pole’, see SB XI 102 and A. [RN1759: 127].”

```
NinNA1 vi 1. ša₂# ina tar₂-kul-lu mah#-ṣu# ta-mur a#-[ta-mar]
BabNB2 iv 1'. [x x x x x x x x] a#-t[a-mar]
```

145

- **N:** lūman | ana ummī[šu | u] ab[īš]u (|) ina nasīh (|) sikkāti | [itt]analla[k]
- **T:** Alas for his mother [and father!] When pegs are pulled out [he] wanders about.'
- **L:** *lūman* ← lūman I "O/jB modal adv."; *ana* ← ana I "(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*..."; *ummī[šu* ← ummu I "f. mother"; *u]* ← u I "and, but, also"; *ab[īš]u* ← abu I "father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*"; *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on"; *nasīh* ← nasāhu I "to tear out"; *sikkāti* ← sikkatu I "peg, nail of wood, copper"; *[itt]analla[k]* ← alāku I "to go"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 904]: "145. Though the two lines do not exhibit a verbatim correspondence, the Akkadian phrase *ina nasīḫ sikkāt*[*im*] evidently corresponds to the Sumerian *{gišma₂*.GAG bu.ra.ni/ba.a} (BN 297). The Akkadian verb is an example of the construct state of the I/1 infinitive in *parīs* (or *parēs*; for this see *GAG*³ §87k; [RN355: 452]). The oldest datable attestation of such an infinitive is in an inscription of Sargon II from Dūr-Šarruken (now [RN145: 78, 30]: *za-qip*), but the presence of another such construct state in the SB epic, *qabī* (var. *qabê*) in SB VI 154, alongside the various other SB attestations adduced by Mayer, is evidence that points to an older origin for the usage. The word *sikkatu*, 'peg', is elicited from *gag*, and though there is plenty of evidence for such a thing in nautical life (e.g. SB XI 64), there may be a confusion with the peg of ownership encountered above in l. 103. In any case, it seems the unfortunate shade will find no rest, being spurred into constant motion every time a peg is pulled out. In the Sumerian poem the variant *ti bu.ra.ni* 'his rib being pulled out' (BN k, Ur MS mm), suggests that the antecedent of this line is one of several dealing with people who have been maimed-in this case the subject was impaled in a boating accident."

```
NinNA1 vi 2. lu-man a-na AMA#-[šu u AD-š]u ina na-sih sik-ka-t[i₃ x x x x x]
BabNB2 iv 2'-3'. [x x x x x x x x x] a-b[i-šu₂] | [x x x x x it-t]a-na-al-la[k
```

146

- **N:** ša mūt (|) ilīš[u | imūtu | t]āmur | ātama[r]
- **T:** 'Did you see the one who [died] a natural death?' '[I saw (him).]
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I "who(m), which"; *mūt* ← mūtu I "death"; *ilīš[u* ← ilu I "pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du."; *imūtu* ← mâtu I "to die"; *t]āmur* ← amāru I "to see"; *ātama[r]* ← amāru I "to see"

- **Note:** See [RN117: 904]: “146. The text of the line’s Sumerian counterpart (BN s 1) can now be properly read for the first time, thanks to MS rr, and this allows at last the correct reading of the Akkadian. The phrase *mūt ilīšu*, lit. ‘death (decided) by one’s god’, occurs in omen apodoses. See especially *YOS* X 18, 55-6: *awīlum*(lú) *ina ḫarrān*(kaskal) *illaku*(du) *i-ma-ra-aṣ-ma i-ma-a-at#*, *u₄#-ma-am r[e-q]a₂-a-am mu-ut ili*(dingir)*-šu awīlum*(lú) *i-ma-a-at*, ‘a man will fall ill and die on a journey he undertakes; (or else) at some future time the man will die “the death of his god”’. Other instances of the phrase are *YOS* X 56 i 16 (ed. [RN839: 202]), *Šumma izbu* VIII 67′ (ed. [RN839: 108]), *Šumma manzāzu* VI 72 (ed. [RN464: 112]), *Pān tākalti* IX 180 and commentary (ed. [RN464: 374, 432]). According to the dictionaries the expression signifies a death of natural causes (as opposed to death by violence or disease) and is therefore a synonym of the more common *mūt šīmti* (or *šīmāti*). The significance of the present passage would then be that those who enjoy the goodwill of a divine guardian in life will also be blessed after death.” See also [NABU2014-5].

```
NinNA1 vi 3. ša₂ mu-ti DINGIR-š[u₂ i-mu-tu t]a-mur [x x x]
BabNB2 iv 4'. [x x x x x x x x] a#-ta-ma[r]
```

147

- **N:** ina mayyāl (|) [il]ī | ṣalil-ma | mê | zakûti | išatti
- **T:** He lies drinking clear water on the bed of the [gods].’
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *mayyāl* ← mayyālu I “bed, resting place Bab., M/NA euph. for grave”; *[il]ī* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *ṣalil-ma* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”; *mê* ← mû I “pl. tant. water *mê kabrūtim* mass of water”; *zakûti* ← zakû I “f. *zakūtu(m)* (NB *cf. zakītu*)”; *išatti* ← šatû II “to drink”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 904]: “147. The second clause is absent from the Nippur sources of the Sumerian poem but now appears on the tablet currently in Norway (BN s 2, MS rr₂). The water is ‘clear’ as opposed to the foul and polluted water (*a ki.lul.la a lu₃.a*) which many shades have to drink (see especially the continuation of the Sumerian poem in the Ur tradition).”

```
NinNA3a vi 1-2. ina ma-a-a#-[al DINGIR-ME]Š ṣa-lil-ma | A-MEŠ [za-ku]-ti i-šat-t
NinNA1 vi 4. ina ma-a-a-al [x x x (x)-m]a A-MEŠ za-ku-ti [x x x]
BabNB2 iv 5'. [x x x x x x x x x x x za]-ku-<ti> i-šat-ti
```

148

- **N:** ša ina tāhāzi | dīku | tāmur | āta[mar]
- **T:** ‘Did you see the one who was killed in battle?’ ‘I [saw (him).]
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *tāhāzi* ← tāhāzu I “pl. f. battle”; *dīku* ← dīku I; *tāmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *āta[mar]* ← amāru I “to see”

- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 287)

```
NinNA3a vi 3. ša ina ta-ha-zi# de#-e-ku ta-mur a#-ta#-[mar]
NinNA1 vi 5. ša₂ ina ta-ha-zi de-ku# ta-mur [x x x]
BabNB2 iv 6'. [x x x x x x x x x] a-t[a-mar]
```

149

- **N:** abūšu | u ummašu | rēssu | našû | aššassu | ina muhhīšu | [ibakk]â[(šu)]
- **T:** His father and mother honour his memory and his wife [weeps] over [(him).]'
- **L:** *abūšu* ← abu I "father (st. constr. *abi*, occas. *abu*, *ab*"; *u* ← u I "and, but, also"; *ummašu* ← ummu I "f. mother"; *rēssu* ← rēšu I "head"; *našû* ← našû II "to lift, carry"; *aššassu* ← aššatu I "wife"; *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on"; *muhhīšu* ← muhhu I "skull"; *[ibakk]â[(šu)]* ← bakû I "to weep"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 904]: "149. The Akkadian follows a tradition in which the first verb is not negated. Both the legible Sumerian manuscripts have a clear negative (BN o 2, MSS mm and rr); the Nippur sources are broken at the crucial point (MSS DD and SS)."
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 288)

```
NinNA3a vi 4-5. AD-šu₂ u AMA-šu₂ SAG-su i[š-šu-u₂] | ($___$) DAM-su ina muh-hi-š
NinNA1 vi 6. AD-šu₂ u AMA-šu₂ SAG#-su na-šu-u₂ u DAM#-[su x x x x x x x x]
BabNB2 iv 7'-8'. [x x x x x x SAG?]-su?# [x x x] | [x x x x x x i-bak-k]a-a-[š
```

150

- **N:** ša šalamtašu | ina ṣēri | nadâ[t] | tāmur | ātamar
- **T:** 'Did you see the one whose corpse was left lying in the open countryside?' 'I saw (him).
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I "who(m), which"; *šalamtašu* ← šalamtu I "pl. *šalmātu* corpse (lit.) of human being, god"; *ina* ← ina I "(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on"; *ṣēri* ← ṣēru I "back, upperside"; *nadâ[t]* ← nadû III "to throw (down)"; *tāmur* ← amāru I "to see"; *ātamar* ← amāru I "to see"
- **Note:** See [RN117: 905]: "150-1. These lines have no counterpart in the Nippur manuscripts of the Sumerian poem but derive from a tradition represented by the Norwegian tablet (BN p, MS rr$_2$): *[lu$_2$] ad$_6$.da.ni edin.na an.na$_2$* (unfortunately not complete)."
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 289)

```
NinNA3a vi 6-7. ša₂ ša₂-lam-ta-šu₂ ina ED[IN] na-d[a-at] | ($___$) ta-mur a-ta-m
NinNA1 vi 7. ša₂ ša₂-lam-ta-šu₂ ina EDIN na-da-a[t x x x x x]
BabNB2 iv 9'. [x x x x x x x x x x x] a#-ta-mar#
```

151

- **N:** eṭemmašu | ina erṣeti | ul ṣalil-ma
- **T:** His ghost does not lie at rest in the Netherworld.’
- **L:** *eṭemmašu* ← eṭemmu I “ghost (of dead person) receiving libations, offerings”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on”; *erṣeti* ← erṣetu I “earth, land”; *ul* ← ul I “not Bab., to negate main clause”; *ṣalil-ma* ← ṣalālu I “to lie (down), sleep Bab., NA”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 289a)

```
NinNA3a vi 8. e-ṭem-ma-šu₂ i-na# KI#-ti₃ ul ṣa-li[l-ma]
NinNA1 vi 8. e-ṭem-ma-šu₂ ina KI-t[i₃ x x x x]
BabNB2 iv 10'. [x x x x x x x x ul ṣa]-lil-ma
```

152

- **N:** ša eṭemmašu | pāqida | lā īšû | tāmur | ātamar
- **T:** ‘Did you see the one whose ghost has no provider of funerary offerings?’ ‘’I saw (him).
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *eṭemmašu* ← eṭemmu I “ghost (of dead person) receiving libations, offerings”; *pāqida* ← pāqidu I “carer (for s.o.) O/jB”; *lā* ← lā I “not, no”; *īšû* ← išû I “to have (no pres., pret. *īši*, *īšu*”; *tāmur* ← amāru I “to see”; *ātamar* ← amāru I “to see”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 290)

```
NinNA3a vi 9-10. ša₂ e-ṭem-ma-šu₂ pa-q[i₂]-da la i-šu-u₂ | ta-mur a-ta-mar
NinNA1 vi 9. ša₂ e-ṭem-ma-šu₂ pa-qi₂-di l[a x x x x x x x x]
```

153

- **N:** šukkulāt (|) diqāri | kusīpāt (|) akali | ša ina sūqi | nadâ | ikkal
- **T:** He eats the scrapings from the pot (and) crusts of bread that are thrown away in the street.’
- **L:** *šukkulāt* ← šukkultu I “dregs, scrapings jB from pots”; *diqāri* ← diqāru I “pl. f. large bowl, tureen Ass., O/jB of clay, stone, copper, bronze”; *kusīpāt* ← kusīpu I “pl. m. & f. bread (crumbs) j/NB”; *akali* ← akalu I; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m…*, *ip-p…* etc.) in, on”; *sūqi* ← sūqu I “pl. m. & f. street Bab., NA”; *nadâ* ← nadû III “to throw (down)”; *ikkal* ← akālu I “to eat”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 905]: “153. For *šukkultu* see [LS441: 211-12]. The Akkadian translation ignores the word following *ninda.pad.pad.ra₂.(ni)* in BN q 2: MS V has *PA.a*, MS DD probably the same (on collation the damaged traces suggested *KAL*) and MSS ll and rr have *PA*.”
- **Parallels:** (Gilgameš, Enkidu, and the Netherworld 291)

```
NinNA3a vi 11–12. šu-ku-la-at di-q[a-r]i ku-si-pat a-ka-li | ($___$) ša₂ ina su-
NinNA1 vi 10. šu#-ku#-la-at di-qa-ri [ku-s]i-pat# a#-ka#-l[i x x x x x x x x x x
```